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NOT FOR RELEASE, PUBLICATION OR DISTRIBUTION, DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY, OUTSIDE INDIA.
THE EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON MAIN BOARD PLATFORM OF BSE LIMITED IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER II OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS")



(Please scan the QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus and the Abridged Prospectus read with the addendum to the Red Herring Prospectus.)



NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED

(To be listed on the main board of BSE)

Our Company was incorporated as 'National Stock Exchange of India Limited' as a public limited company under the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated November 27, 1992 issued by the Assistant Registrar of Companies, Maharashtra at Bombay and commenced its operations pursuant to a certificate of commencement of business dated March 2, 1993 issued by the Additional Registrar of Companies, Maharashtra at Bombay. For further details, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" beginning on page 249 of the red herring prospectus dated September 10, 2026 (the "RHP" or the "Red Herring Prospectus").
Registered Office and Corporate Office: Exchange Plaza, C-1, Block G, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India; **Telephone:** +91 22 2659 8100; **Website:** www.nseindia.com; **Contact person:** Smt. Prajakta Powle (Company Secretary and Compliance Officer);
E-mail: nse_ipo@nse.co.in; **Corporate Identity Number:** U67120MH1992PLC069769

OUR COMPANY DOES NOT HAVE AN IDENTIFIABLE PROMOTER

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO 126,436,650 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("OUR COMPANY" OR "THE COMPANY") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING TO ₹[•] MILLION (THE "OFFER") THROUGH AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO 126,436,650 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING TO ₹[•] MILLION BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS AS PROVIDED IN ANNEXURE A OF THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS (SUCH EQUITY SHARES SO OFFERED, THE "OFFERED SHARES", AND SUCH OFFER, THE "OFFER FOR SALE").
THE OFFER INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹700.00 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [•]% OF THE POST OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY) FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES (THE "EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION"). THE OFFER LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET OFFER". THE OFFER AND THE NET OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE [•]% AND [•]%, RESPECTIVELY, OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

DETAILS OF THE OFFER FOR SALE BY THE TOP 10 SELLING SHAREHOLDERS			
NAMES OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS**	TYPE	MAXIMUM NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OFFERED/ AMOUNT (IN ₹ MILLION)	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE (IN ₹)*
State Bank of India	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 15,969,410 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	0.80
Canada Pension Plan Investment Board	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 11,874,060 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	324.13
Aranda Investments (Mauritius) Pte Ltd	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 11,246,336 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	62.38
MS Strategic (Mauritius) Limited	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 11,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	66.54
The New India Assurance Company Ltd.	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 10,500,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	0.32
SBI Capital Markets Limited (SS)*	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 8,780,590 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	0.38
Bank of Baroda	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 7,690,375 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	0.54
Stock Holding Corporation of India Limited	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 6,187,500 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	0.46
General Insurance Corporation of India	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 6,187,500 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	5.26
United India Insurance Company Limited	Corporate Selling Shareholder	Up to 6,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating to ₹[•] million	0.50

*As certified by Manian & Rao, Chartered Accountants (FRN: 001983S), by way of their certificate dated September 10, 2026.
**For a complete list of the Selling Shareholders and details of their weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share, see "Annexure A" of the Red Herring Prospectus on page 623 and 624.
*SBI Capital Markets Limited is also participating as a Selling Shareholder in the Offer. On account of the restrictions under Regulation 21A of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations, SBI Capital Markets Limited, in its capacity as a book running lead manager to the Offer, will be involved only in the marketing of the Offer.

PRICE BAND: ₹1,700 TO ₹1,785 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH.
THE FLOOR PRICE IS 1,700 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 1,785 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.
BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 8 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 8 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH THEREAFTER.
THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FINANCIAL YEAR ENDED 2026 FOR OUR COMPANY AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 42.89 TIMES AND AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 40.85 TIMES AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER P/E RATIO OF 54.28 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.
A DISCOUNT OF ₹170 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION.
WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NETWORTH FOR LAST THREE FISCAL YEARS IS 37.92%.

The details of the Offer for Sale and the post Offer market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

OFFER SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION				
Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹1,700 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹1,785 per Equity Share	
	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)
Offer For Sale	126,436,650	214,864.53*	126,436,650	225,615.74*
Post Offer Market Capitalisation	2,475,000,000	4,207,500.00	2,475,000,000	4,417,875.00

*Offer size has been calculated considering the employee discount of ₹170 per Equity Share at Floor price and Cap price.

BID/OFFER PROGRAMME

BID/OFFER OPEN

BID/OFFER CLOSES ON MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 21, 2026⁽ⁱ⁾

⁽ⁱ⁾ The UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7.00 p.m. on the Bid/Offer Closing Date.

We operate a vertically integrated, multi-asset class stock exchange offering a simple integrated platform for trading, clearing and listing, and other services such as data feed, data terminal and licensing services, across cash market, futures, options, mutual funds platform, commodity derivatives, exchange-traded currency derivatives, wholesale debt market and interest rate futures, among others.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.
THE EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE LIMITED. BSE LIMITED SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.
QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET OFFER • NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET OFFER
RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET OFFER • EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹1 AGGREGATING UP TO ₹700.00 MILLION

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS READ WITH THE ADDENDUM TO THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT DATED SEPTEMBER 14, 2026 ("ADDENDUM") AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendation of a committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated September 10, 2026, the above provided Price Band is justified based on quantitative factors/ key performance indicators ("KPIs") disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" section on page 130 of the RHP vis-a-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary and secondary transactions, as applicable, as disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" section beginning on the page 130 of the RHP and provided below in this advertisement.

Risk to Investors
For details, refer to section titled "Risk Factors" on page 26 of the RHP.

1. **Trading Volume Risk:** We earn revenue based on trades executed on our stock exchange, listing fees from Listed Entities, and fees from ancillary services such as data feed & terminal services, data centre related services, and licensing services, and any significant decrease in the volume and value of such transactions could significantly reduce demand for our products, constrain our growth and have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition, results of operations, cash flows and prospects.

Revenue from operations from:	Three months period ended June 30,				Fiscal					
	2026	% of Revenue from operations	2025	% of Revenue from operations	2026	% of Revenue from operations	2025	% of Revenue from operations	2024	% of Revenue from operations
Transaction charges	36,226.64	79.44%	31,536.00	78.20%	130,570.12	78.65%	136,357.64	79.55%	121,296.37	82.07%
Listing services	783.59	1.72%	776.42	1.93%	3,524.36	2.12%	3,138.21	1.83%	2,226.18	1.51%
Data Centre - Rack charges	593.88	1.30%	458.17	1.14%	2,051.75	1.24%	1,544.02	0.90%	1,338.14	0.91%
Data Connectivity charges	2,582.94	5.66%	2,881.31	7.15%	11,287.91	6.80%	11,044.81	6.44%	8,246.97	5.58%
Data Feed & Terminal services	1,495.57	3.28%	1,063.80	2.64%	4,700.74	2.83%	4,071.32	2.38%	3,392.64	2.30%
Licensing services	441.29	0.97%	378.01	0.94%	1,518.45	0.91%	1,204.98	0.70%	975.36	0.66%
Clearing & Settlement Services	823.58	1.81%	492.87	1.22%	2,514.51	1.51%	3,213.42	1.87%	1,348.12	0.91%
Others	317.40	0.69%	327.10	0.81%	1,428.34	0.87%	1,260.01	0.75%	855.71	0.57%
Total	43,264.89	94.87%	37,913.68	94.03%	157,596.18	94.93%	161,834.41	94.42%	139,679.49	94.51%
Other operating revenues ⁽ⁱ⁾	2,339.21	5.13%	2,408.70	5.97%	8,416.91	5.07%	9,572.37	5.58%	8,120.62	5.49%
Total	45,604.10	100.00%	40,322.38	100.00%	166,013.09	100.00%	171,406.78	100.00%	147,800.11	100.00%

Notes:
⁽ⁱ⁾ Comprises income generated from investment of funds related to operating activities.

2. **Risk relating to concentration of revenue from Transaction Charges:** Our business significantly depends on revenue from trading activities and in turn we earn the majority of our trading revenue from our options and futures businesses. The table below provides our revenue from the transaction charges for the period/Fiscal indicated:

Particulars	Three months period ended June 30,		Fiscal		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
Revenue from operations (A)	45,604.10	40,322.38	166,013.09	171,406.78	147,800.11
Revenue from operations from transaction charges (B)	36,226.64	31,536.00	130,570.12	136,357.64	121,296.37
As % of revenue from operations (B)/(A)	79.44%	78.20%	78.65%	79.55%	82.07%
Transaction charges from options business (C)	27,439.47	23,726.85	99,975.68	101,940.30	95,501.89
As % of revenue from operations (C)/(A)	60.17%	58.84%	60.22%	59.47%	64.62%
Transaction charges from futures business (D)	3,674.81	3,820.46	14,800.97	17,272.58	12,489.75
As % of revenue from operations (D)/(A)	8.06%	9.47%	8.92%	10.08%	8.45%
ADTV in the options (premium value)	643,517.81	555,136.09	576,617.54	624,486.60	617,788.39
ADTV in the futures	1,530,788.97	1,684,296.36	1,594,432.13	1,859,014.41	1,340,003.40

Particulars	Three months period ended June 30,		Fiscals		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
Aggregate absolute value of the revenue from the top ten trading members	21,431.89	18,385.84	77,655.80	76,238.40	66,894.18
Percentage of revenue from operations (%)	47.00%	45.60%	46.78%	44.48%	45.26%
4. Regulatory Oversight and Inspection Risk: We operate in a highly regulated industry, primarily overseen by SEBI. We are also subject to periodic inspections by SEBI and IFSCA and pursuant to such inspections, have received observations, show cause notices, and administrative warnings, deficiency and advisory letters in relation to certain regulatory matters, and after issuance of show cause notices, enforcement actions including adjudication proceedings under Section 15-I and/or directions or penalties under Section 11B of the SEBI Act may be initiated by SEBI; any failure to comply could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations. There can be no assurance that further such communications will not be issued in the future.					
5. Enforcement and Adjudication Risk: We have been, and continue to be, subject to enforcement actions, monetary penalties, adjudication proceedings, which may or may not get settled with SEBI in respect of alleged violations and regulatory matters with applicable SEBI regulations. The outcome of current and potential future proceedings is uncertain and could have a material adverse impact on our business, reputation, financial condition and results of operations.					

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6. **IT Infrastructure Reliability Risk:** Disruptions, failures or inadequacies in our IT infrastructure, systems or software, including those provided by third-party vendors, could adversely affect our business, reputation and results of operations, and may subject us to regulatory action or the imposition of financial disincentives by SEBI.

7. **New Listings and Capital Formation Dependence Risk:** Our ability to attract new listings, issuances and capital formation activities on our platforms is critical to our business, and any decline may adversely affect our operations. The table below provides revenue from our listing services for the period/Fiscal indicated:

Particulars	Three months period ended June 30,		Fiscal		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
Revenue from listing services (A)	783.59	776.42	3,524.36	3,138.21	2,226.18
Revenue from operations (B)	45,604.10	40,322.38	166,013.09	171,406.78	147,800.11
As a % of revenue from operations (A/B)	1.72%	1.93%	2.12%	1.83%	1.51%
Listed Entities on Exchange*	3,005	2,757	2,978	2,719	2,438

14. The weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share by the Selling Shareholders as on the date of the Red Herring Prospectus is as follows and upper end of the Price Band is ₹1,785 per Equity Share:

15. Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted by the Selling Shareholders in the three years, 18 months and one year immediately preceding the Red Herring Prospectus is as follows:

Period	Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition of Equity Shares (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition	Range of acquisition price: Lowest Price – Highest Price (in ₹)
Last one year	1,954.51	0.91	1,860.00 to 2,015.00
Last 18 months	1,795.70	0.99	1,485.00 to 2,260.00
Last three years	1,247.92 ^a	1.43	564.84 ^a to 2,260.00 ^a

^APursuant to resolution passed by our Governing Board on November 4, 2024, our Company undertook a bonus issue of Equity Shares in the ratio of 4:1 (i.e., four Equity Shares for every one Equity Share held in our Company) as of the record date of November 2, 2024 ("**Bonus Issue**"). The Bonus Issue has been excluded from the calculation in the table above. However, the Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition of Equity Shares and range of acquisition price of equity shares transacted prior to the Bonus Issue has been adjusted.

**Pursuant to resolution passed by our Board on November 4, 2024, our Company undertook a bonus issue of Equity Shares in the ratio of 4:1 (i.e., four equity shares for every one equity share held in our Company) as of the record date of November 2, 2024. Acquisition price of Equity Shares acquired pursuant to such bonus issue is N.A.*

Name	Total Public Issues^	Issue closed below issue price on listing date
BRLMs		
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited*	-	-
JM Financial Limited*	-	-
Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited**	-	-
Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited*	-	-
HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited*	-	-
J.P. Morgan India Private Limited*	-	-
Anand Rath Advisors Limited*	1	-
Aventus Capital Private Limited*	-	-
Axis Capital Limited*	1	-
DAM Capital Advisors Limited*	3	-
Equirus Capital Limited (<i>formerly known as Equirus Capital Private Limited</i>)*	1	-
HDFC Bank Limited*	-	-
ICICI Securities Limited**	-	-
IDBI Capital Markets & Securities Limited*	-	-
IIFL Capital Services Limited (<i>formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited</i>)*	1	-
Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited*	3	2
Nuvama Wealth Management Limited*	1	-
Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited*	10	3
360 ONE WAM Limited*	-	-
M-BRLM		
SBI Capital Markets Limited*5	-	-
Common Issues handled by the BRLMs and M-BRLM	150	42
Total	171	47

⁵ SBI Capital Markets Limited is participating as a Selling Shareholder in the Offer and is an associate of State Bank of India, a Selling Shareholder in the Offer, in terms of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations. On account of the restrictions under Regulation 21A of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations and Regulation 23(3) of the ICDR Regulations, as applicable, SBI Capital Markets Limited, in its capacity as a book running lead manager to the Offer, will be involved only in the marketing of the Offer.

1. The Company has not undertaken a pre-IPO placement from the DRHP till date.
2. Our Company does not have an identifiable promoter in terms of SEBI ICDR Regulations and the Companies Act 2013. Consequently, there are no members forming part of the 'promoter group' in terms of the SEBI ICDR Regulations.
3. For the pre-Offer shareholding and post-Offer shareholding of the top 10 public Shareholders, refer to the section titled "*Capital Structure*" on page 112 of the RHP and our price band advertisement.



Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):		Bid/ Offer Programme
Bid/Offer Period (except the Bid/Offer Closing Date)		Event
		Indicative Date
Submission and Revision in Bids	Only between 9.00 a.m. and 7.00 p.m. IST	Anchor Investor Bid/Offer Date Wednesday, September 16, 2026
Bid/Offer Closing Date		Bid/Offer Opens On Thursday, September 17, 2026
Submission of electronic applications (online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) for RIBs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 7.00 p.m. IST	Bid/ Offer Closing Date Monday, September 21, 2026
Submission of electronic application (bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and syndicate ASBA applications through UPI as a payment mechanism where Bid Amount is above ₹0.20 million)	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST	Finalisation of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange On or about Tuesday, September 22, 2026
Submission of electronic applications (syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications)	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST	Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/unblocking of funds from ASBA Account* On or about Wednesday, September 23, 2026
Submission of Physical Applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST	Credit of Equity Shares to demat accounts of Allottees On or about Wednesday, September 23, 2026
Submission of physical applications (syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications where Bid Amount is more than ₹0.50 million)	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST	Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on BSE On or about Thursday, September 24, 2026
Modification/Revision/cancelled of Bids		<i>*In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date for cancelled/ withdrawn/ deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchange bidding platform up to the date on which the amounts are unblocked (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs and the BRLM shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The Bidders shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of our Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable, issued by SEBI, and any other applicable law in case of delays in resolving investor grievances in relation to blocking/unblocking of funds. The processing fees for applications made by the UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism may be released to the remitting banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation on compliance with SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which has also prescribed that all individual investors applying in initial public offerings opening on or after May 1, 2022, where the application amount is up to ₹0.50 million, shall use UPI. RIBs, Eligible Employees Bidding under Employee Reservation Portion for up to ₹0.50 million (net of the Employee Discount) and individual investors Bidding under the Non-Institutional Portion Bidding for more than ₹0.20 million and up to ₹0.50 million, using the UPI Mechanism, shall provide their UPI ID in the Bid-cum-Application Form for Bidding through Syndicate, sub-syndicate members, Registered Brokers, RTAs or CDPs, or online using the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account (3 in 1 type accounts), provided by certain brokers.</i>
Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders categories*	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Offer Closing Date	
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIBs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion	Only between 9.00 a.m. and up to 7.00 p.m. IST	

* UPI mandate end time shall be 7:00 p.m. on the Bid/Offer Closing Date.

* QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their bids.

On the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, the Bids shall be uploaded until:

(i) 4:00 p.m. IST in case of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders, and

(ii) until 7:00 p.m. IST or such extended time as permitted by the Stock Exchange, in case of Bids by RIBs and Eligible Employees Bidding under the Employee Reservation Portion.

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ASBA*

Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

*Applications Supported by Blocked Amount ("ASBA") is a better way of applying to offers by simply blocking the fund in the bank account.

For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues.

No cheque will be accepted.

UPI

UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE

UPI-Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. UPI Bidders also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press release dated June 25, 2021 read with press release dated September 17, 2021, and CBDT circular no. 7 of 2022 dated March 30, 2022, read with press release dated March 28, 2023, and any subsequent press release in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Category; (ii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 500,000 in the Non-Institutional Portion; (iii) Eligible Employee bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion with an application size of upto ₹ 500,000 (net of Employee Discount). For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and abridged prospectus and also please refer to the section "Offer Procedure" on page 530 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India ("AIBI") and BSE and in the General Information Document. The Bid Cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the website of BSE Limited ("BSE") (the "Stock Exchange") and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFp=yes&intmId=35 and <https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFp=yes&intmId=43>, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited, State Bank of India (In its capacity as Sponsor Bank) and Axis Bank Limited have been appointed as the Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of SEBI circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs and M-BRLM on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and email Id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORM OF BSE.

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/Offer Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchange, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on websites of the BRLMs, M-BRLM and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and intimation to SCSBs, Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Banks as applicable.

The Offer is being made in compliance with Regulation 45 of the Securities Contracts (Regulation) (Stock Exchange and Clearing Corporations) Regulations, 2018, as amended ("SECC Regulations"). This is an Offer in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI/ICDR Regulations. This Offer is being made through the Book Building Process in compliance with Regulations 6(1) and 32(1) of the SEBI/ICDR Regulations wherein not more than 50% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to QIBs (such portion the "QIB Portion") provided that our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI/ICDR Regulations ("Anchor Investor Portion"), of which 40% shall be reserved as under: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds; and (ii) 6.67% shall be reserved for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the price at which Equity Shares will be allocated to the Anchor Investors ("Anchor Investor Allocation Price"), in accordance with the SEBI/ICDR Regulations. Any under-subscription in the reserved category specified in clause (ii) above, may be allocated to domestic Mutual Funds. In the event of under-subscription or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion (excluding the Anchor Investor Portion) ("Net QIB Portion"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion ("Mutual Fund Portion") shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Mutual Funds only and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs (other than Anchor Investors) including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to NIBs of which (a) one third portion shall be reserved for NIBs with application size of more than ₹0.20 million and up to ₹1.00 million; and (b) two-thirds of the portion shall be reserved for NIBs with application size of more than ₹1.00 million, provided that the unsubscribed portion in either of such sub-categories may be allocated to Bidders in the other sub-category of NIBs in accordance with SEBI/ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price and not less than 35% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to RIBs in accordance with the SEBI/ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees Bidding under the Employee Reservation Portion, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. All Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are required to mandatorily utilise the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("ASBA") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID (in case of UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism), in which case the corresponding Bid Amounts will be blocked by the SCSBs or under the UPI Mechanism, as applicable to participate in the Offer. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Anchor Investor Portion of the Offer through the ASBA process. For details, see "Offer Procedure" beginning on page 530 of the RHP.

Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN and the Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID available (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the

Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants' sole risk.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of the Company as regards its Objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 249 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" on page 592 of the RHP.

Liability of the Members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of Share Capital of our Company and Capital Structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹5,000,000,000 Equity Shares divided into 5,000,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up pre-Offer Equity Share capital of our Company is ₹2,475,000,000 divided into 2,475,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each. For details of the capital structure of the Company, see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 112 of the RHP.

Names of the Initial Signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the number of equity shares subscribed by them: The initial signatories of the Memorandum of Association of the Company are as follows: Arindrajit Lahiri, General Insurance Corporation of India, G. Sreerama Murthy, Industrial Credit and Investment Corporation of India Limited, Industrial Development Bank of India, Life Insurance Corporation of India and Ravi Narain who each subscribed to 1 Equity Share of face value ₹10 each. For details of the share capital history of our Company please see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 112 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares that will be offered through the Red Herring Prospectus are proposed to be listed on BSE. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approval from BSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to its letter dated July 20, 2026. For the purposes of the Offer, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be BSE. A signed copy of the Red Herring Prospectus has been delivered to the RoC in accordance with Section 32 of the Companies Act, 2013 and a signed copy of the Prospectus shall be delivered to the RoC in accordance with Section 26(4) of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/Offer Closing Date, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" beginning on page 592 of the RHP.

Disclaimer Clause of Securities and Exchange Board of India: SEBI only gives its observations on the offer documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Offer or the specified securities listed in the Offer Documents. The investors are advised to refer to page 470 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer Clause of BSE (the Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE Limited should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE Limited nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to the page 475 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of BSE.

General Risks: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Bidders are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Offer have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the investors is invited to "Risk Factors" beginning on page 26 of the RHP.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER				
				
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited 27 BKC, 1 st Floor, Plot No. C - 27, "G" Block Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 4336 0000 E-mail: nse.ipo@kotak.com Investor grievance e-mail: kmccredressal@kotak.com Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com Contact person: Ganesh Rane SEBI registration no.: INM000008704	JM Financial Limited 7 th Floor, Chenergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030 E-mail: nseipo@jmfml.com Investor grievance e-mail: grievance.ibd@jmfml.com Website: www.jmfml.com Contact person: Prachee Dhuri SEBI registration no.: INM000010361	Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited* Altimus, Level 39 & 40, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli Mumbai 400 018 Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6118 1000 E-mail: nseipo@morganstanley.com Investor grievance e-mail: investors_india@morganstanley.com Website: www.morganstanley.com/india Contact person: Priyank Rekhan SEBI registration no.: INM000011203	Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited 1202, 12 th Floor, First International Financial Centre (FIFC) G-Block Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East) Mumbai 400 098 Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6175 9999; E-mail: nseipo@citigroup.com Investor grievance e-mail: investors.cgmib@citigroup.com Website: https://www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india Contact person: Naman Kulshreshtha SEBI registration no.: INM000010718	HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited 52/60, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Fort, Mumbai 400 001, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6864 1289 E-mail: nseipo@hscbc.co.in Investor grievance e-mail: investorgrievance@hscbc.co.in Website: www.business.hsbc.co.in Contact person: Harsh Thakkar / Harshit Tayal SEBI registration no.: INM000010353
				
J.P. Morgan India Private Limited J.P. Morgan Tower, Off C.S.T. Road, Kalina Santacruz (East), Mumbai 400 098 Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6157 3000 E-mail: NSE_IPO@jpmorgan.com Investor grievance e-mail: investorsmb.jpmip@jpmorgan.com Website: www.jpmip.com Contact person: Vidit Jain / Rishank Chheda SEBI registration no.: INM000002970	Anand Rathi Advisors Limited 11 th Floor, Times Tower, Kamla City Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel Mumbai 400 013 Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 4047 7000 E-mail: nse.ipo@rathi.com Investor grievance e-mail: grievance.ecm@rathi.com Website: www.anandrathiib.com Contact person: Pranav Nagar / Junaid Raza SEBI registration no.: INM000010478	Aventus Capital Private Limited Platina Building, 9 th Floor 901, Plot No C-59 Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East) Mumbai 400 051 Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6648 0050 E-mail: nse.ipo@avendus.com Investor grievance e-mail: investorgrievance@avendus.com Website: www.avendus.com Contact person: Sarthak Sawa / Sneha Roy SEBI registration no.: INM000011021	Axis Capital Limited Axis House, 1 st Floor, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai 400 025 Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 4325 2183 E-mail: nse.ipo@axiscap.in Investor grievance e-mail: complaints@axiscap.in Website: www.axiscapital.co.in Contact person: Simran Gadh SEBI registration no.: INM000012029	DAM Capital Advisors Limited Altimus 2202, Level 22, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai 400 018, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 4202 2500 E-mail: nse.ipo@damcapital.in Investor grievance e-mail: complaint@damcapital.in Contact person: Arpi Chheda / Puneet Agnihotri Website: www.damcapital.in SEBI registration no.: MB/INM000011336
				
Equirus Capital Limited (formerly known as Equirus Capital Private Limited) Unit No. 2601B, 26th Floor, A Wing Marathon Futrex, Mafatlal Mills Compound, NM Joshi Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai 400 013, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 4332 0736; E-mail: nse.ipo@equirus.com Investor grievance e-mail: investorsgrievance@equirus.com Website: www.equirus.com Contact person: Malay Shah / Mrunal Jadhav SEBI registration no.: INM000011286	HDFC Bank Limited Investment Banking Group Unit no. 701, 702 and 702-A, 7 th floor, Tower 2 and 3, One International Centre, Senapati Bapat Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai 400 013 Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 3395 8233; E-mail: nse.ipo@hdfc.bank.in Investor grievance e-mail: Investor.redressal@hdfcbank.com Website: www.hdfc.bank.in Contact person: Gaurav Khandelwal / Souradeep Ghosh SEBI registration no.: INM000011252	ICICI Securities Limited* ICICI Venture House Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi Mumbai, 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 6807 7100 E-mail: nse.ipo@icicisecurities.com Investor grievance e-mail: customercare@icicisecurities.com Website: www.icicisecurities.com Contact person: Aboli Pitre / Hitesh Malhotra SEBI registration no.: INM000011179	IDBI Capital Markets & Securities Limited 6th Floor, IDBI Tower, WTC Complex, Cuffe Parade Mumbai 400 005 Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 4069 1953 E-mail: nse.ipo@idbicapital.com Investor grievance e-mail: redressal@idbicapital.com Website: www.idbicapital.com Contact person: Indrajit Bhagat SEBI registration no.: INM000010866	IIFL Capital Services Limited (formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited) 24 th Floor, One Lodha Place, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai 400 013 Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 4646 4728 E-mail: nse.ipo@iiflcap.com Investor grievance e-mail: ig.ib@iiflcap.com Website: www.iiflcapital.com Contact person: Dhruv Bhavsar / Pawan Kumar Jain SEBI registration no.: INM000010940
				REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER 
Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited Motilal Oswal Tower, Rahimtullah Sayani Road Opposite Parel ST Depot, Prabhadevi Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 7193 4380 E-mail: nse.ipo@motilaloswal.com Investor grievance e-mail: motiapi@redressal@motilaloswal.com Website: www.motilaloswal.com Contact person: Kunal Thakkar / Ronak Shah SEBI registration no.: INM000011005	Nuvama Wealth Management Limited 801 - 804, Wing A, Building No 3, Inspire BKC, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East Mumbai 400 051 Maharashtra, India Telephone: +91 22 40094400 E-mail: nse.ipo@nuvama.com Investor grievance e-mail: customerservice.mb@nuvama.com Website: www.nuvama.com Contact person: Lokesh Shah SEBI registration no.: INM000013004	Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited Pantomath Nucleus House, Saki Vihar Road, Andheri East, Mumbai 400 072, Maharashtra, India Telephone: 1800 889 8711 E-mail: nse.ipo@pantomathgroup.com Investor grievance e-mail: investors@pantomathgroup.com Website: www.pantomathcapital.com Contact person: Amit Maheshwari SEBI registration no.: INM000012110	360 ONE WAM Limited 360 ONE Centre, Kamala City, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai 400 013 Maharashtra, India. Telephone: +91 22 4031 7000 E-mail: nse.ipo@360.one Investor grievance e-mail: mbinvestorcomplaints@360.one Website: www.360.one Contact person: Devesh Patkar SEBI registration no.: INM000012801	MUFG Intime India Private Limited (Formerly Link Intime India Private Limited) C-101, Embassy 247, L.B.S. Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai 400 083 Maharashtra, India. Telephone: +91 810 811 4949 E-mail: nse.ipo@in.mpsms.mufg.com Investor grievance e-mail: nse.ipo@in.mpsms.mufg.com Website: www.in.mpsms.mufg.com Contact person: Shanti Gopalakrishnan SEBI registration no.: INR000004058

COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER

Smt. Prajakta Powle

National Stock Exchange of India Limited

Exchange Plaza, C-1, Block-G, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051 Maharashtra, India. **Telephone:** +91 22 2659 8100; **E-mail:** secretarialdept@nse.co.in; **Website:** www.nseindia.com

Investors may contact the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any pre-Offer or post-Offer related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Offer related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

*Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited and ICICI Securities Limited are associates of MS Strategic (Mauritius) Limited and ICICI Lombard General Insurance Company Limited, Selling Shareholders in the Offer, respectively, in terms of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations. Accordingly, in terms of Regulation 21A of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations and Regulation 23(3) of the SEBI/ICDR Regulations, Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited and ICICI Securities Limited would be involved only in the marketing of the Offer. Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited and ICICI Securities Limited have signed the due diligence certificate and have been disclosed as BRLMs.

*SBI Capital Markets Limited is participating as a Selling Shareholder in the Offer and is an associate of State Bank of India, a Selling Shareholder in the Offer, in terms of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations. On account of the restrictions under Regulation 21A of the SEBI Merchant Bankers Regulations and Regulation 23(3) of the SEBI/ICDR Regulations, as applicable, SBI Capital Markets Limited, in its capacity as a book running lead manager to the Offer, will be involved only in the marketing of the Offer.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP: Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the "Risk Factors" beginning on page 26 of the RHP before applying in the Offer. A copy of the RHP will be made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and is available on the websites of the BRLMs, Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited at <https://investmentbank.kotak.com>; JM Financial Limited at www.jmfml.com; Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited at www.morganstanley.com/india; Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited at <https://www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india>; HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited at www.business.hsbc.co.in; J.P. Morgan India Private Limited at www.jpmip.com; Anand Rathi Advisors Limited at www.anandrathiib.com; Aventus Capital Private Limited at www.avendus.com; Axis Capital Limited at www.axiscapital.co.in; DAM Capital Advisors Limited at www.damcapital.in; Equirus Capital Limited (formerly known as Equirus Capital Private Limited) at www.equirus.com; HDFC Bank Limited at www.hdfc.bank.in; ICICI Securities Limited at www.icicisecurities.com; IDBI Capital Markets & Securities Limited at www.idbicapital.com; IIFL Capital Services Limited (formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited) at www.iiflcapital.com; Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited at www.motilaloswal.com; Nuvama Wealth Management Limited at www.nuvama.com; Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited at www.pantomathcapital.com; SBI Capital Markets Limited at www.sbicaps.com and 360 ONE WAM Limited at www.360.one and at the website of the Company, National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com and the websites of the Stock Exchange, for BSE at www.bseindia.com.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the Abridged Prospectus shall be available on the website of our Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Offer at: www.nseindia.com, <https://investmentbank.kotak.com>; www.jmfml.com; www.morganstanley.com/india; <https://www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india>; www.business.hsbc.co.in; www.jpmip.com; www.anandrathiib.com; www.avendus.com; www.axiscapital.co.in; www.damcapital.in; www.equirus.com; www.hdfc.bank.in; www.icicisecurities.com; www.idbicapital.com; www.iiflcapital.com; www.motilaloswal.com; www.nuvama.com; www.pantomathcapital.com; www.sbicaps.com and www.360.one and www.in.mpsms.mufg.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORM: Bid cum Application Form can be obtained from the Registered Office of the Company, National Stock Exchange of India Limited, Telephone: +91 22 2659 8100; BRLMs: Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4336 0000, JM Financial Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030, Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6118 1000, Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6175 9999, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6864 1289, J.P. Morgan India Private Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6157 3000, Anand Rathi Advisors Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4047 7000, Aventus Capital Private Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6648 0050, Axis Capital Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4325 2183, DAM Capital Advisors Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4202 2500, Equirus Capital Limited (formerly known as Equirus Capital Private Limited), Telephone: +91 22 4332 0736, HDFC Bank Limited, Telephone: +91 22 3395 8233, ICICI Securities Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6807 7100, IDBI Capital Markets & Securities Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4069 1953, IIFL Capital Services Limited (formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited), Telephone: +91 22 4646 4728, Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited, Telephone: +91 22 7193 4380, Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Telephone: +91 22 40094400, Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited, Telephone: 1800 889 8711, 360 ONE WAM Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4031 7000, SBI Capital Markets Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4006 9807 and Syndicate Members: Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6281 7000, Asit C. Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, Telephone: +91 22 2858 3333, +91 9769989513, Equirus Securities Private Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4332 0800, HDFC Securities Limited, Telephone: +91 22 3075 3400, Investec Capital Services (India) Private Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6849 7400, JM Financial Services Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6136 3400, Kotak Securities Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4285 8484, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Telephone: +91 22 7193 4200/+91

22 7193 4263, Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4009 4400, SBICAP Securities Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6943 2521, Sharekhan Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6750 2000, Spark Institutional Equities Private Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6885 4503/+91 44 4344 0078/+91 992 0931 711,+961 090 Distribution Services Limited, Telephone: +91 9321332882, Registered Brokers, SCSBs, Designated RTA Locations and Designated CDP Locations for participating in the Offer. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the website of the Stock Exchange at www.bseindia.com and at all the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available on the websites of the Stock Exchange and SEBI.

SUB-SYNDICATE MEMBERS: 5Paiza Capital Limited; Alankit Imaginations Limited; Almondz Global Securities Limited; Ambit Capital Limited; Ambit Private Limited; Amrapali Capital & Finance Services Limited; Anand Share Consultancy; ANS Private Limited; Arihant Capital Markets Limited; Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited; Asit C Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited; Axis Securities Limited; Bajaj Financial Services Limited; Bob Capital Markets Limited; Centrum Broking Limited; Centrum Capital Advisors Limited; Centrum Finverse Limited; Centrum Wealth Management Limited; Choice Equity Broking Private Limited; Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Private Limited; DB(International) Stock Brokers Limited; Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Limited; G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited; Girraj Stock Broking Private Limited; Globe Capital Market Limited; ICICI Securities Limited; Indusind Securities Limited; Inga Ventures Private Limited; Innovate Securities Private Limited; Intensive Fiscal Services Private Limited; Jhaveri Securities; Jobanputra Fiscal Services Private Limited; Kalpataru Multiplier Limited; Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Private Limited; Keynote Capitals Limited; KJMC Capital Market Services Limited; Lakshminshree Investment & Securities Private Limited; LKP Securities Limited; Marwadi Shares & Finance Limited; Monarch

QUICKLY.

India accounts for 20% of all chip designers: Intel

New Delhi: India now accounts for about 20 per cent of the global chip design and very large scale integration (VLSI) workforce, with more than 85,000 semiconductor engineers trained in the last four years, said a senior executive from Intel. Speaking at Semicon India 2026 here on Thursday, Srinivasan Iyengar, Senior V-P, Fellow and General Manager at Intel's Central Engineering Group, said India was well-positioned to play a larger role in the semiconductor industry, particularly as demand for chips grows. SANJANA B

ASML to up India presence as Tata fab takes shape

New Delhi: ASML is stepping up its presence in India as the country moves towards building its first 300 mm semiconductor fab, with the Dutch semiconductor equipment maker planning to expand its customer support, supplier and broader ecosystem footprint, a senior executive said on Thursday. Earlier this year, Tata Electronics and ASML signed an MoU to advance semiconductor manufacturing in India. ASML sees India's semiconductor market reaching \$110-120 billion by 2030. SANJANA B

AI data centres to drive 20% of Infineon's revenue

New Delhi: AI data centres are set to account for about 20 per cent of Infineon's revenue as the semiconductor industry increasingly focuses on the power infrastructure needed to support the growing AI compute demand, the company's CEO, Jochen Hanebeck, said on Thursday. He said that the AI opportunity extends beyond GPUs, models and memory to the power-generation, transmission, storage and delivery systems needed to run increasingly power-intensive data centres. SANJANA B

Tata Electronics tops in MoUs inked



BUSY DAY. Visitors at the Tata Electronics kiosk at Semicon India 2026 in New Delhi on Thursday. The company is set to sign 16 pacts over the next couple of days REUTERS

S Ronendra Singh

New Delhi

Tata Electronics signed the most number of pacts on the sidelines of the Semicon India 2026 conference here on Thursday.

The company also announced the setting up of a 363-acre vendor park for its suppliers in Dholera, Gujarat.

In Dholera, Tata Electronics has brought together more than 450 ecosystem partners to build the fab, spanning construction, equipment, chemicals and material partnerships. The vendors can acquire land here, which will have a plug-and-play infrastructure in terms of power, utility and roads, the company said.

‘ON TRACK’

The company will sign 16 agreements at the conference with players across Europe, Japan, Singapore, and India, its Chief Executive Officer, Randhir Thakur, said.

He said the fab in Dholera and the packaging facility in Assam, were “on track” to meet scheduled commitments made to the government.

“Five years ago, the India

Files to factories: Modi maps India’s chip journey

MAKING INDIA A HUB. PM urges youth to contribute to tech advancement; IT Minister Vaishnaw says industry to invest ₹1 lakh crore over two-three years

S Ronendra Singh

New Delhi

With India entering the commercial chip production stage after years of policy-making, project approvals and construction, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday said the country's semiconductor journey has moved from “files to factories”.

The shift is accompanied by a fresh wave of private investment. At the Semicon India 2026 here on Thursday, Electronics and IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said companies have committed around ₹1 lakh crore over the next two-three years. The announcements point to a broader transition in the government's strategy —

from attracting individual semiconductor projects to building an ecosystem spanning fabs and packaging to chip design, equipment, materials, research and development (R&D) and talent.

“TAKING EVERY STEP”

“The world is looking for new and trusted manufacturing destinations; India is steadily preparing itself to meet this need.. India is taking every step needed to become a preferred destination for the semiconductor industry,” Modi said while inaugurating the conference's fifth edition.

The PM also noted that Indian-made chips have already started reaching customers worldwide for the first time. The development of a semiconductor ecosys-



AND IT TAKES OFF. Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw at the inauguration of Semicon India 2026 in New Delhi on Thursday PMO

tem requires capabilities spanning chip design, equipment, materials, testing and packaging, said Modi, while urging industry leaders to

deepen domestic R&D. He also encouraged Indian researchers working overseas to contribute to advanced technology development in

the country. “Young talents who are researching in India should come forward; the youth who are researching abroad should also join the

development of advanced technologies in India,” he added.

The government approved the second phase of the Semicon India programme in July with an outlay of ₹1.275 lakh crore. The first phase of the semiconductor mission, launched in 2021, was largely aimed at proving that India could attract fabrication and packaging investments. The government committed roughly ₹76,000 crore and ultimately approved 12 semiconductor manufacturing projects worth more than ₹1.64 lakh crore.

INVESTMENTS SOON

Vaishnaw said the latest investment spans a wide swathe of the semiconductor ecosystem, including equip-

ment, materials, gases, chemicals, ATMP units, substrates and wafers.

Without naming companies, he said the players are expected to make announcements after securing approvals from their boards and shareholders. The target is of five to six years, but the companies are expected to invest within the next three years, he said.

He added that the pipeline gives the government a clear view of the investment trajectory ahead under the ambitious second phase of India's semiconductor programme.

The investment interest also comes within weeks of the government notifying Semicon 2.0 that could generate close to 1 lakh new jobs, Vaishnaw added.

‘India emerging as global semiconductor hub’

S Ronendra Singh

New Delhi

With favourable policies and faster project approvals under the Semicon programme, semiconductor companies on Thursday said India is emerging a key hub for the global chip industry, prompting them to scale up operations in the country.

Micron CEO Sanjay Mehrotra said the company plans to scale its chip assembly and testing facility in Sanand, Gujarat, multifold next year. Speaking at the inaugural session here, he said, “This year, we will assemble and test tens of millions of chips at Sanand. Next year, hundreds of billions of chips.”

Micron designs memory chips in Bengaluru and Hyderabad, assembles them in Gujarat and ships them to customers across every continent, said Mehrotra. He added that Micron's current production capacity already exceeds the memory re-



It's really amazing to see how India has actually fuelled itself to not just be a part of [the semiconductor ecosystem], but to sort of lead it from the front

SRINIVASAN IYENGAR

Senior V-P, Intel

quirement of India's entire laptop market.

NUCLEUS TO GROWTH

Similarly, Srinivasan Iyengar, Senior Vice-President and General Manager of the Central Engineering Group at Intel, said India was advancing on a journey from “good to great”, propelled by its vast talent pool, academic innovation and growing base of deep-tech startups.

“Semiconductors are the very nucleus to the growth and what we do on a daily

basis, especially with the Agentic AI world out here. And it's really amazing to see how India has actually fuelled itself to not just be a part of it, but to sort of lead this from the front. I think India is positioned extremely well to do that,” Iyengar added.

RESEARCH PARK

Semiconductor equipment maker Applied Materials said it plans to invest \$5 billion in India over the next 10 years, aimed at accelerating and integrating the country's green energy ecosystem into the global value chain. “In 2024, we ordered India's first 300-millimetre lab. Today, we are committing to a new 140-acre advanced semiconductor research park, bringing together clean room capabilities, engineering expertise, and collaborative R&D with customers and suppliers on one site,” Prabhu Raja, President for Semiconductor Product Group, Applied Materials, said.

Applied Materials to invest \$5 b

Sanjana B

New Delhi

Applied Materials has committed \$5 billion over the next decade to expand its semiconductor R&D, supply chain and talent footprint in India, as the US chip equipment maker looks to integrate the country more deeply into the global value chain.

Speaking at Semicon India 2026 on Thursday, Prabhu Raja, President of Semiconductor Products Group at Applied Materials, said: “This has a three-pillar approach. One, deepen our R&D in India. Two, accelerate the ecosystem in India. Three, grow future talent in India..”

By 2035, the company aims to grow its India-based supply chain capacity ten times, creating opportunities for Indian suppliers. This will help Applied Materials broaden its geographic footprint, too.



Saying that AI had one defining challenge, of requiring more powerful and energy-efficient chips, Raja said addressing it would require a new approach to innovation.

A PARALLEL MODEL

Raja also called for a parallel model that enables high-velocity innovation and high-volume manufacturing, bringing equipment makers, customers, suppliers and universities together. He said India has the talent base to lead this model if it continues to develop and connect talent with advanced technology labs and training.

ALL ABOUT CHIPS



MEET AND GREET. (Clockwise from top left) Visitors posing for a selfie at the Semicon India conference in New Delhi on Thursday; A man operates a humanoid robot at the AMD kiosk; Lars Reger, CTO, NXP Semiconductors NV; Takatoshi Kyo, President, Disco Hi-Tec; Visitors seen in queues outside the conference venue at Yashobhoomi in the national capital ANI, REUTERS, BLOOMBERG

India ‘can embed AI in semicon making process from outset’

Our Bureau

New Delhi

India has an opportunity to build artificial intelligence into new semiconductor manufacturing operations from the outset, avoiding the need to change established processes of older manufacturing ecosystems, industry executives said at Semicon India 2026.

Speaking at a panel discussion on ‘AI Transforming Industry’, David Fried, Vice-President and Chief AI Officer, Lam Research, said established semiconductor companies were undertaking changes to business processes and tools developed over decades.

India's emerging manufacturing ecosystem, he said, could adopt AI from inception as new fabs and equip-

TWO SIDES

- Prakash Raghavendra, Senior Fellow, Software Systems at AMD, said AI was enabling hardware and software to be optimised together
- Lam Research's Fried opined that the AI-led semiconductor demand was straining manufacturing operations and supply chains

ment manufacturing operations come up. “We can be doing these things in totally different ways,” Fried said.

MANY OPPORTUNITIES

Accordingly, the opportunity extends beyond accelerating existing processes to developing different ways of designing equipment and running manufacturing operations.

Providing an example, Micron's Shisheer Kotha said the company's advanced defect classification solution

was being deployed at its Gujarat assembly and test facility. The solution processes around 100 million images a month across the company's front-end and back-end manufacturing facilities, helping identify defect patterns and improve inspection outcomes.

Notably, Kotha said Micron's Hyderabad team accounted for 70 per cent of the contribution to the solution. Besides manufacturing, panellists highlighted opportunities to use AI to improve

chip design and verification.

According to Navin Bishnoi, V-P and Country Head, India at Marvell, chip development cycles span two to three years, creating a challenge. He identified verification as an area where AI could accelerate workflows.

AMD's Prakash Raghavendra said AI was enabling hardware and software to be optimised together, including identifying where hardware changes were necessary to up software performance.

LEARNING CURVE

On talent, Ritesh Tyagi, V-P and Global Head, Silicon, Wipro, said learning agents had helped shorten the learning curve for new engineers. Further, Kotha called for greater opportunities for Indian talent to undertake research and solve complex problems.

Industry seeks targeted support for semicon equipment R&D

Our Bureau

New Delhi

India needs dedicated government incentives for developing semiconductor equipment, components and subsystems domestically if it wants to build a deeper local manufacturing ecosystem, said a senior executive at the KAS Group of Companies.

Speaking on developing India's equipment R&D and manufacturing ecosystem, he said the government support should extend beyond fabs to the wider technology and supply chain.

The executive also called for a dedicated support to develop semiconductor tools, subsystems and components in India.

EXPANDING PRESENCE

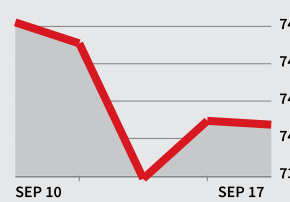
Takatoshi Kyo, President, Disco Hi-Tec, said the Japanese semiconductor equipment maker is stepping up its commitment to India through training and engineering skills development. Disco, which specialises in cutting, grinding and polishing technologies, has established a training centre in Gujarat in partnership with the Pandit Deendayal Energy University.

The company aims to train engineers who can support India's emerging semiconductor ecosystem. Disco has supplied products to the Indian market since the 1990s and expects its presence to grow.

Yoshiaki Yoshida, Director and Chairperson of the Board of Advantest Corporation, said the company is also expanding its engineering and R&D presence in India. Advantest, which began operations here in 2013, now has offices in Chennai and Bengaluru.

the hindu businessline

SENSEX 74314.59 (-21.86)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23270.60	+53.00
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	19.69	0
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.93	-0.02
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	151241.00	-511
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	229642.00	-1695

FLIGHT PATH.

LCA delays, engine deals shaping Hindustan Aeronautics' growth roadmap, says CMD Ravi K **p7**



SEASONAL JOBS.

Festival online shopping boom creates 2.7 lakh temporary jobs across e-comm, q-comm **p10**

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QUICKLY.

EU QUOTA BOOST

India gets duty-free access for 2.8 mt steel exports



New Delhi: Indian steel exporters have secured potential duty-free access to 2.8 million tonnes (mt) of steel exports to the EU annually, even before the India-EU free trade agreement (FTA) comes into force, a government official said. This includes a guaranteed country-specific quota of 1.9 mt, plus another 0.9 mt of access through residual quotas available to free trade partners. **p3**

COST BURDEN

'SEBI will examine brokers concerns over UPI fee'

Mumbai: The Securities and Exchange Board of India will examine concerns raised by stock brokers over the new merchant discount rate (MDR) on UPI transactions, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said on Thursday as the industry raised concerns about the additional costs that could arise from client fund transfers. "I think there are some important issues there. We will certainly look into it and see how we can ease them," Pandey said. **p6**

Chandra gets 3rd term at Tata Sons, Noel opposes it

BATTLE LOOMS. Tata Trusts term the resolution 'legal nullity' under Tata Sons' articles

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

A bitter boardroom confrontation erupted at Tata Sons on Thursday as directors voted to give N Chandrasekaran another five-year term as Executive Chairman, despite opposition from majority shareholder Tata Trusts, whose Chairman Noel N Tata told the board that the resolution was legally void. The clash over Chandra's future unfolded alongside a larger dispute over the future structure of Tata Sons and the implications of the Reserve Bank of India's decision on its NBFC status.

Four directors voted in favour of Chandrasekaran's reappointment, while Noel Tata, one of the two Tata Trust nominee directors, voted against it. The Trusts subsequently said the resolution was a "legal nullity" under Tata Sons' Articles of Association (AoA).

The confrontation came barely five weeks after Chandrasekaran himself told the board that he would not seek another term after his tenure ends on February 20, 2027. The Trusts said they accepted that decision the following day and asked Tata Sons to begin the process of appointing a successor.

PAGE HAD TURNED

Noel told the board that Chandrasekaran's August 12 decision was his own, "freely taken and clearly expressed",

The Trust tussle

- **Oct 11, 2024:** Noel Tata becomes Chairman of Tata Trusts
- **Jul 28, 2025:** Tata Trusts unanimously backs N Chandrasekaran and recommends a fresh five-year term as Executive Chairman of Tata Sons from February 2027
- **Sept 2025:** The Tata Sons board agrees in principle to Chandra's reappointment, with formal approval slated for February 2026
- **Oct 28, 2025:** Mehli Mistry is voted out of the boards of SDTT and SRTT amid opposition from the Noel Tata camp
- **Feb 2026:** The Tata Sons board fails to reach unanimity on Chandra's extension, leading to the proposal being deferred



of the boards of SDTT and SRTT amid opposition from the Noel Tata camp

the Tata Sons board fails to reach unanimity on Chandra's extension, leading to the proposal being deferred

N Chandrasekaran

- **Aug 12, 2026:** Chandra informs the Tata Sons board that he will not seek another term after February 20, 2027
- **Aug 13, 2026:** SDTT accepts Chandra's decision and begins the process of forming a committee to identify a successor
- **Aug 2026:** SRTT restrictions block meetings and nominations to the Tata Sons chairman-selection committee
- **Aug 18, 2026:** Tata Sons' AGM is adjourned for the first time in its history due to a lack of quorum
- **Sept 11, 2026:** SRTT curbs remain, delaying succession planning, trustee appointments and grant approvals



Noel Tata

and was not the result of any board review or resolution. Once made public, he argued, employees, lenders, counterparties, the market and the majority shareholder had all acted on it. "The page has turned," Noel said.

The Trusts maintain that the AoA requires both Trust nominee directors to be present and vote in favour for a Chairman's appointment or reappointment to be valid. Since Noel voted against Chandrasekaran's reappointment, the Trusts said the resolution was "legally void and without any basis". Noel also submitted a legal opinion from former Chief Justice of India DY Chandrachud supporting the Trusts' interpretation

which, they said, was not taken note of by the board. Noel further argued that the reappointment was premature because Chandrasekaran's position as a director remained unresolved, with the relevant general meeting unable to proceed for want of quorum.

NBFC ISSUE

The board was also grappling with the RBI's September 11 decision declining Tata Sons' application to surrender its NBFC registration. Noel pointed out that the RBI communication does not itself mention listing and urged the board to examine alternatives and seek legal advice before deciding its

course. "What is at stake is something very fundamental. The nature and character of the Tata Group as a unique institution," Noel said in a statement

Adding another twist, Noel tabled an SP Group proposal to monetise part of its Tata Sons stake to generate at least ₹25,000 crore, through a two-tranche buyout over 18 months and a selective capital reduction process through the NCLT.

The boardroom battle may now move to the courtroom. Sandeep Parekh, Founder of Finsec Law Advisors, said in a social media post that the larger contest could shift to the courts.

Coverage on p2

Stalemate gave Chairman 'casting' vote on his own reappointment

Raghuvir Srinivasan
Chennai

In the boardroom battle at Tata Sons on Thursday, the Noel Tata camp was banking on Article 121A, under which majority approval from the nominees of the Tata Trusts is needed on a list of specified items that are put to vote.

With just two nominees — Venu Srinivasan and Noel Tata — representing the Trusts on the Tata Sons board and the two in opposing camps, the expectation was of a stalemate during voting for the reappointment of N Chandrasekaran as Chairman of Tata Sons.

POWER PLAY

Yet, what transpired was that Srinivasan's vote supporting the reappointment was accepted while Tata's vote opposing the move was rejected. How did this happen?

According to one of the directors present at the board meeting, the company secretary of Tata Sons was armed with legal opinion, stating that a stalemate between the two trustees could be broken by a casting vote from the Chairman.

So, in effect, the Chairman of Tata Sons, Chandrasekaran, voted for his own reappointment!



The board has decided to "comply" with the RBI directive regarding its status as an Upper Layer NBFC **BLOOMBERG**

"The act has just started, many more scenes to go," the director said when asked if this would be legally contested by Tata.

COMPLIANCE CALL

Meanwhile, the director, who wished to remain anonymous, said that the board had decided to "comply" with the RBI directive regarding its status as an Upper Layer NBFC.

"The term used was comply; what that means is something that the company has to talk to the RBI and go by what the regulator says," the director said.

The next step is for the general body meeting to be called to approve the reappointment of Chandrasekaran as Chairman. "With the freeze on Sir Ratan Tata Trust, we have to

see how it goes... work out the modalities so that shareholders can vote," the director said.

He pointed out that the road ahead is not going to be easy for the company.

One of the reasons that the board supported the reappointment was that it didn't want the focus on business to be lost.

"There's tremendous work to be done in Air India and on the semiconductor projects; the digital business needs to be turned around," the director pointed out.

Asked if this is going to be a long-drawn boardroom fight, the director said: "There are multiple issues. I hope that sense will prevail. There's a long way to go, and I don't think anybody can predict as to what will happen," he said.

India holds firm on Russian energy choice despite looming threat of higher US tariffs

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

India is holding firm on its decision to source energy from Russia and has signalled that it will not allow the threat of higher US tariffs to dictate its energy choices, even as it prepares for the possibility of additional levies by Washington following the US House of Representatives passing the Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act on Wednesday.

The Ministry of External Affairs, in a statement on Thursday, said its energy procurement and response

to trade measures will be guided by its national interests. It also cautioned that targeting India through the legislation could adversely affect the bilateral relationship as also the global energy market.

"This issue has been discussed at high levels in recent months with various US interlocutors. Its potential implications for not just the bilateral relationship but also the international energy market have been very clearly articulated by the Indian side," the MEA statement noted.

The House passed the Sanctions Bill on Wednesday, sending it forward to US



President Donald Trump for his signature. Once signed into law, it will give Trump the authority to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on major buyers of Russian energy, including India.

"We are monitoring further developments on this matter... India remains firmly committed to ensur-

ing energy security for its 1.4 billion people. It will continue to do so through diversified sourcing and on the basis of evolving market dynamics," the MEA said.

In FY26, India bought \$40.8 billion worth of crude oil from Russia, accounting for nearly a third of its total oil imports by value, per industry data.

RUSSIA, CHINA SLAM US

The US move has also drawn criticism from Russia and China. Kremlin spokesperson Dmitry Peskov said additional US sanctions would complicate efforts to reach a peace settlement in Ukraine. Beijing rejected what it

called US "long-arm jurisdiction".

The MEA said India was "determined" to protect its trade and economic interests. "Government will work closely with Indian trade and industry bodies to deal with the implications of these developments," the statement said.

The new US Act turns sanctions into a trade weapon against India for concessions under a "deeply unequal" bilateral trade agreement, Ajay Srivastava of the trade research body GTRI noted. "India should not trade away its energy security for temporary tariff relief," he added.

LODGINGS AT SEA



FLOATING ASIAD VILLAGE. The Costa Serena cruise ship, which is housing athletes for the Asian Games, at the Nagoya Port in Japan. The Asian Games 2026 officially opens on Saturday and will go on till October 4, though competitions in several disciplines will begin before the opening ceremony. The cramped accommodation attracted criticism, with rooms meant for two allotted to three. Japanese athletes are said to be looking at alternative accommodation **PTI**

Prices of premium rice varieties surge by 50% on fears of lower kharif output

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Prices of premium rice varieties have surged by 50 per cent since last year on fears that production of the cereal could be lower this year, particularly in the South, as farmers planted less due to deficit rainfall.

"The area under premium rice varieties, such as Ponni and Sona Masuri, has been affected in Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh and Telangana. The coverage could be 30-40 per cent lower," said BV Krishna Rao, President of the Rice Exporters Association.

"Not only in the South, but in other parts of the country such as Uttar Pradesh and Bihar, too, the area under rice has declined this kharif season," said S Chandrasekaran, a New Delhi-based trade analyst.



PRICEY GRAINS. Grade 1 BPT rice prices in Andhra Pradesh have increased to ₹6,200 a quintal from ₹4,000 a year ago

SOUTH AREA DOWN 28% According to the Ministry of Agriculture, the area under paddy declined by 16.97 lakh hectares (lh) this year to 426.81 lh, down from 443.78 lh a year ago. Rao said the production could decline by over 10 million tonnes.

The Ministry's Crop Weather Watch Group said the major decrease in the area coverage of paddy had been reported in Karnataka

(4.54 lh), Telangana (4.46 lh), Andhra Pradesh (1.9 lh), Uttar Pradesh (1.84 lh), Madhya Pradesh (1.75 lh), Tamil Nadu (1.4 lh), Maharashtra (1.15 lh) and Jharkhand (0.97 lh).

The decline is mainly because the southern region received deficient rainfall during the South-West monsoon (28 per cent deficit as of September 17).

Grade 1 BPT rice prices in

Andhra Pradesh have increased to ₹6,200 a quintal from ₹4,000 a year ago.

"Premium rice prices are around ₹80 a kg, be it Sona Masuri, Ponni or any such variety. The trade is factoring in the prospect of low production of these varieties," said New Delhi-based exporter Rajesh Paharia Jain. "This cannot serve any purpose. Our production of premium rice varieties has been declining. A committee was set up to study the demand for such rice a couple of years ago. What happened to the committee's report?" wondered Chandrasekaran.

PRICEY AS BASMATI

Jain said premium rice variety prices will likely rise further and may rule near the rates of basmati. "Prices cannot go above basmati as consumers will shift to the fragrant rice variety then," he said.

Brookfield to invest up to \$600 million in ACME's green molecule projects in India and West Asia

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The ACME Group said on Thursday that Brookfield will invest up to \$600 million in ACME Cleantech Ventures to support the development and construction of an advanced pipeline of ACME's green molecule projects in India and West Asia.

ACME Cleantech Ventures is a UK-based privately held entity within the ACME Group, dedicated to the Group's green molecules projects.

GREEN DRIVE

ACME's arm is advancing the development of new green ammonia and green methanol facilities in India and Oman, further strengthening its position as a leading developer of scalable, cost-competitive green molecules solutions for the domestic and global markets. It has se-



Manoj Upadhyay, Chairman of ACME Group

cured strategic offtake partnerships with Yara International of Norway, IHI Corporation of Japan, Mitsubishi Gas Chemicals, Solar Energy Corporation of India and Indian fertilizer companies such as IFFCO, Paradeep Phosphates, Coromandel International and Indorama India.

Brookfield is pursuing the investment in ACME through its Brookfield Global Transition Fund

strategy, which focuses on investing in opportunities that accelerate the transition to a net-zero carbon economy. The investment will enable the development of green molecule projects as a scalable solution to help industries decarbonise their operations across Asia and Europe.

REGIONAL BET

Naval Saini, Managing Partner and Head of Energy for South Asia and the Middle East at Brookfield, said, "Demand for green molecules continues to grow as companies and governments seek scalable solutions to decarbonise while strengthening energy security."

"This investment marks Brookfield's entry into the green molecules sector in the region and combines our global scale and institutional capital with ACME's operating capabilities. ACME has an attractive project pipeline

to capture the growing energy transition opportunity in India and West Asia," he added.

Manoj Upadhyay, Chairman of the ACME Group, said that green molecules are creating a new supply chain for fuel and feedstock globally while strengthening the long-term energy security of nations.

"As we develop our world-class green ammonia and other green molecule projects, we aim to accelerate cost-competitive decarbonisation and build a global platform serving customers in Asia, Europe and beyond," he added.

ACME's strong project portfolio, underpinned by long-term, bankable offtake contracts with blue-chip counterparties creates a solid foundation for generating largescale sustainable cash flows over the long term, he said.

Also read p2

US-based private equity firm Advent International said on Thursday it will invest ₹3,150 crore in Yatharth Hospital for a 24.9 per cent stake, sending shares of the Indian hospital operator to a record high. Shares rose as much as 8.6 per cent to an all-time high of ₹1,067 . The deal adds to a wave of private equity investments in India's healthcare sector. Yatharth Hospitals was established in 2008 and primarily operates in northern India. REUTERS

Our Bureau
Mumbai

TRUST GOVERNANCE
 "Chandra is treading on thin ice despite getting a re-appointment," said a senior lawyer, noting that the issue has moved beyond the boardroom into a wider battle over shareholder rights and trust governance. Legal experts argue that a board resolution alone cannot secure Chandrasekaran's five-year term. Since the Chairman must also continue as a director, his position ultimately depends on

LISTING ROUTE

Nazneen Ichhaporia, Partner at ANB Legal, said the RBI's rejection of Tata Sons' deregistration request had significantly raised the stakes, particularly as most board members are believed to favour a listing route while

He added that the Trusts had questioned the legality of the board meeting and may seek judicial intervention. Meanwhile, Sandeep Parekh, founder of Finsec Law Advisors, said in a social

With shareholder approval pending, trust-level disputes unresolved and listing questions still alive, the next chapter is likely to play out before regulators and courts rather than in the boardroom.

#end-2017 to end-2025 *till September 16

But given the recent slowdown in investor participation, trading volume and higher regulatory tightening, it will be wrong to expect NSE to give out-sized returns, similar to BSE, at least in the short term.

"Therefore, what is at stake today is something very fundamental: the nature and character of the Tata Group as a unique institution. What makes the Tata operating structure unique is



that it is premised on trust and its majority shareholder is a charity. That charity funds hospitals, universities, and research from the dividends it receives. It exists for public purpose and for nation building,” Noel Tata said.

“It is the operating model of this house, and it has stood the test of time for more than a century. A listing will destroy its character and strike at the heart of this

“The position of the Tata Trusts has remained consistent and unchanged,” Noel said in a statement.

line on the sidelines of the 6th International Ferro Alloys Conference 2026 on Thursday in Goa.

Manish Sarda, Chairman, the Indian Ferro Alloy Producers' Association said India is the world's largest exporter of manganese alloys and the second-largest producer of manganese alloys, after China.

The geopolitical disruptions led to the decline, say

Kotak Institutional Equities' report on automobiles and components said that exports saw weak trends

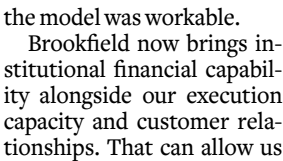
She drew attention to utility vehicle exports, which she noted, rose 23 per cent to around 2.03 lakh units during April-August FY27.

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Three or four years ago, hydrogen and green ammonia started with a very big bang. But because of bankability issues, offtake issues, complexity and infrastructure gaps, projects got delayed worldwide.

What does the investment specifically change for ACME?
We started with our Bikaner proof-of-concept facility,

which demonstrated how the entire photon-to-electron-to-molecule conversion could happen and what the costs could be. That gave customers confidence that



The equity valuation is expected to be decided by the end of 2026. ACME will maintain a significant majority in its projects and business entities. Oman Phase 1

Can green ammonia follow solar's transition from expensive

A We have seen this transition before in solar. Solar started at around \$15, but when tariffs came down to around \$2.44, the industry stopped thinking in megawatts and started building gigawatts. We want to play the same role in green ammonia. Scale, technology and selecting locations with the strongest renewable-energy resources can bring costs down. If you want people to move from grey to green, you have to offer them a competitive price. Customers cannot be expected to pay an exorbitant price simply to make that transition.

Come September

Fed rate hike ups the ante for other central banks

The Federal Open Market Committee concluded a watershed meeting on Wednesday, when it raised its benchmark funds rate by 25 basis points to 3.75-4 per cent, its first hike after 2023. It also indicated that there are more hikes to come in December and beyond. Market observers would also have noticed that the Fed under its new Chair Kevin Warsh, regarded as a favourite of President Trump, is not keen to do what Trump wants him to — which is, to keep rates low.



At last month’s Jackson Hole meet, Warsh made it clear that he would focus on inflation — which has been above the target 2 per cent level for 65 months — above all else. The US Treasury Department and the Fed are not on the same page now. But first, the message coming out of the FOMC September meet to the world at large is that ‘higher rates are here to stay for longer’. The Fed median funds rate has been pegged at 4.1 per cent in 2027, 3.9 per cent in 2028 and 3.6 per cent in 2029 (higher than June projections), which suggests more hikes in the next calendar year, to deal with 3.6 per cent inflation in 2026. In fact, its members expect a rate hike of 25 basis points in December, with a few even pushing 50 bps. The wars and, of course, Trump’s tariff tantrums have injected higher inflation and volatility everywhere. With global rates rising, the Reserve Bank of India will have to decide whether it should prioritise external stability over the domestic economy. While FPI outflows have crossed 2025 levels already, the FCNR surplus is a source of comfort. But a rise in the dollar immediately after the FOMC decision suggests that RBI will have to be mindful of the differentials between Indian and US rates.

A steep US yield curve is perhaps here to stay for the next few years, for a variety of factors. The 10-year US Treasury yields are hovering at 19-year highs of 5 per cent. Whether this situation reduces elbow room for manoeuvre in the rest of the world will be a key question facing central bankers. A rise in the overnight rate may not flatten the US yield curve, as the demand for long term funds from AI hyperscalers is expected to rise in coming years. The budget deficit of 6 per cent of GDP (\$1.9 trillion) too is raising the yields of 10-year and 30-year paper. Higher servicing costs and unrestrained spending are acting as market triggers.

The Fed’s differences with the government are evident. Warsh believes that long-term yields are best left to market forces without any need for forward guidance. But Trump and his Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent would like to keep these under check, so that the cost of servicing the budget deficit can be reined in. A growth rate of 2.3 per cent with strong labour data does not suggest that growth needs a boost. But Trump believes that overnight rates should be low, possibly to offset the tariff impact. In these times of flux, there will be more safe haven investment and a rising dollar for the world, and India, to contend with.

OTHER VOICES.

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

EUROPE

Mark Zuckerberg offers an AI dissent

Confronted by political pressure, companies can behave like a swarm of AI bots. We saw that with the corporate embrace of the environmental, social and governance agenda, and now with AI leaders calling for government to regulate development. Credit to Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg for injecting a note of common sense into the debate. “Every lab has the responsibility and incentive to move at the pace required to train its models safely, and the ability to take its own actions to ensure that happens,” Mr. Zuckerberg wrote on social media. He correctly explained that companies already have strong incentives to build robust safeguards and not to rush out new models without adequate testing. (NEW YORK, SEPTEMBER 16)



Iran cannot have it both ways

Those observing the past few days in the Middle East will have witnessed alarming Houthi gains in Yemen and the shelving of Iran-Gulf talks planned for Oman. It is likely that those same observers will also perceive a clear contradiction in Tehran’s approach; Iran cannot credibly seek better relations with its Gulf neighbours while continuing to enable armed groups that threaten and attack those same neighbours. The latest escalation in Yemen has laid bare this contradiction. The Houthis — who enjoy Iran’s support — have claimed responsibility for more attacks on Saudi Arabia. As well as displacing an estimated 80,000 people, the fighting has come at the cost of any tangible diplomatic progress. (ABU DHABI, SEPTEMBER 15)



INDU BHUSHAN

For more than seven decades, the Central Government Health Scheme (CGHS) has provided healthcare security to serving and retired government employees and their families. Long before health insurance became a mainstream policy objective in India, CGHS established an important principle: illness should not expose families to financial hardship and people should have access to quality healthcare when they need it.

That principle remains as relevant today as it was in 1954. But the system built around it needs to change.

The issue goes well beyond CGHS. The Railways, the Ex-Servicemen Contributory Health Scheme (ECHS), the Central Armed Police Forces and several State governments operate their own health schemes for employees and pensioners. Their institutional arrangements differ, but many face a common challenge: inadequate budget provision, increasing pool of beneficiaries, rising healthcare costs, fragmented purchasing arrangements and inadequate incentives for either providers or beneficiaries to use resources efficiently.

As healthcare costs continue to rise at double-digit rates, this model cannot remain fiscally sustainable indefinitely.

The government’s recent revision of CGHS reimbursement rates was timely and necessary. Hospitals cannot be expected to provide quality care at rates that bear little relationship to the cost of delivering it. But periodically increasing reimbursement rates without reforming the underlying purchasing system risks treating the symptom rather than the disease.

PAYMENT PROCESS

The more fundamental question is not simply how much government pays for healthcare, but how it pays for it. This is where reform must begin.

First, government schemes need to move decisively away from fee-for-service payment. Under fee-for-service, every additional consultation, investigation or procedure generates additional revenue for the provider. The incentives therefore favour more services rather than better outcomes or greater efficiency.

Wherever feasible, payment should instead be based on well-defined treatment packages. A hospital treating a patient for a particular condition should receive a predetermined amount covering the entire episode of care, rather than billing separately for every investigation, procedure and consumable. Over time, India should move towards more sophisticated systems such as diagnosis-related groups, which adjust payments for the complexity of patients while encouraging efficient treatment. Better-designed packages would reduce both administrative complexity and opportunities for over-treatment.

Second, medicines offer another major opportunity for efficiency.



RAGU R

Government health schemes at a crossroads

OPTIMAL SPENDING. Better-designed treatment packages that reduce both administrative complexity and opportunities for over-treatment are needed

Government should use its enormous purchasing power far more effectively. Generic medicines of assured quality should be the default across government schemes, supported by strong formularies, bulk procurement, better inventory management and prescription audits.

The potential savings are substantial. Medicine expenditure is one of the fastest-growing components of CGHS expenditure, with excessive dependence on purchases through authorised local chemists rather than more efficient procurement channels. The objective should not be to restrict access to medicines but to obtain the same quality at a substantially lower cost.

Third, gatekeeping needs to become much more effective. A health system in which patients can move directly to expensive specialist and tertiary care without appropriate clinical referral will inevitably become costly.

CGHS already has an important asset in its network of wellness centres. These should become genuine coordinators of care — providing strong primary care, managing chronic diseases, ensuring preventive screening and referring patients to specialists when clinically necessary. Similar mechanisms should be strengthened in ECHS, Railways and state employee schemes. Effective gatekeeping is not about denying care. It

Public health programmes ultimately depend on partnerships. Governments finance healthcare, providers deliver healthcare and patients benefit from healthcare

is about ensuring that the patient receives the right care, at the right level, at the right time.

Fourth, we need a mature discussion about beneficiary contributions. When healthcare is completely free at the point of use, with virtually unlimited benefits, some degree of moral hazard is inevitable. This does not justify imposing substantial financial burdens on pensioners or people with serious illnesses. But modest and carefully designed co-payments or deductibles for selected services, particularly treatment in private hospitals, deserve consideration.

Such provisions can be differentiated by income, age and type of service, with appropriate exemptions for vulnerable groups and chronic conditions. Even a small element of cost sharing can influence utilisation behaviour without undermining financial protection.

STRUCTURAL ISSUE

There is also a larger structural question. Why should different arms of government separately empanel hospitals, negotiate prices, process claims, build IT systems and establish anti-fraud mechanisms for essentially similar populations?

Greater convergence across CGHS, ECHS, ESI, Railways and other government schemes could create larger risk pools and vastly strengthen the government’s purchasing power. This effort should be led by the National Health Authority that implements my most cherished scheme Ayushman Bharat. Complete institutional merger may take time and may not always be feasible, but common provider networks, standard treatment packages, shared technology platforms, interoperable claims systems and

coordinated price negotiations should be entirely achievable. State governments could increasingly adopt the same architecture.

None of this diminishes the importance of fixing the operational problems that providers rightly highlight today. Payments must be timely. Hospitals need visibility into the claims lifecycle. Grievances and disputes must be resolved within clearly defined timelines. Digital platforms should simplify rather than complicate transactions. Fraud controls must be strong but should not become an excuse for delaying legitimate payments.

Public health programmes ultimately depend on partnerships. Governments finance healthcare, providers deliver healthcare and patients benefit from healthcare. When providers have confidence in the system, they are more willing to invest, innovate and expand capacity. When confidence weakens, the impact is eventually felt by beneficiaries.

CGHS has been one of India’s most enduring healthcare success stories. The opportunity before policymakers today is not to dismantle what has worked but to strengthen its foundations for the future — and to apply these lessons across government health schemes.

The recent revision in CGHS rates was an important first step. The next step must be more ambitious: moving from simply paying healthcare bills to strategically purchasing healthcare. That is the transition required to ensure that the schemes relied upon by millions remain affordable, efficient, transparent and trusted by those who sustain them every day.

The writer, a Senior Associate with Johns Hopkins University, was founding CEO of Ayushman Bharat

RAVIKANTH

POCKET



● **LETTERS TO EDITOR** Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

UPI backlash

This refers to ‘Balancing Act’ (September 17). A merchant MDR of 0.4 per cent on eligible transactions above ₹2,000 is not expected to impose any direct additional burden on users. But more than the actual financial impact, the psychological pressure it has created among users needs attention. Trader bodies have already indicated that they may insist on cash payments, while some traders have said they may recover the cost from consumers. Hence, more than the actual impact, the possible exploitation that this levy could lead to is what the government should be mindful of.

Given the negative perception the move has created, care should be taken to ensure that it does not encourage a shift back to cash and take payment reforms back to square one.

Srinivasan Velamur
Chennai

Difficult to opt out

UPI has become so deeply embedded in everyday transactions that opting out is increasingly difficult. Its convenience has created widespread dependence among consumers and merchants. Once a digital payment system becomes indispensable, the possibility of

introducing charges becomes far more consequential. The concern is whether users, after being encouraged to shift away from cash, will eventually have to pay for that convenience.

UPI’s near-monopoly deserves close scrutiny: when one payment ecosystem dominates, consumer choice weakens and the cost of dependence can rise.

Harsh Pawaria ‘Noni’
Rohtak, Haryana

A cue for merchants

Apropos Ravikanth’s timely and hilarious cartoon, ‘Sale: Any item ₹2,000 — now ₹1,999’ (September

17). With a 0.4 per cent charge on UPI transactions above ₹2,000 effective October 15, merchants may have a new reason to rethink their pricing. The cartoon captures the situation perfectly and is funny, sharp, and very relevant. A good cue for merchants to stay one step ahead in business.

PV Prakash
Mumbai

Forex inflows

With reference to ‘Dollar deluge: options for liquidity management’ (September 17). Large foreign-currency inflows present both an opportunity and a policy

challenge. Excess liquidity can ease immediate pressures, but absorbing it without creating distortions requires careful calibration. The RBI should assess the durability of the inflows before choosing between foreign-exchange swaps, open-market operations and other instruments.

Monetary management should avoid creating incentives for short-term capital while ensuring adequate liquidity for productive economic activity. Transparent communication would help markets understand the rationale behind policy choices.

SP Suganya Devi
Coimbatore



GST on MDR debate

MDR may dent digital adoption, GST sharpens risk

Mohan R Lavi

Since no MDR is charged on UPI transactions, there is consequently no GST.” With these words, the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) put to rest, in April 2025, rumours that UPI payments above ₹2,000 would be taxed. From October 15, merchants will pay a Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) of 0.4 per cent for person-to-merchant UPI payments above ₹2,000, capped at ₹300, with a flat ₹5 for categories such as railways, telecom, fuel and insurance.

Where there is MDR, there is GST at 18 per cent. The law plainly permits the levy. The question is whether it should be imposed.

LEGAL POSITION

The MDR is the consideration charged for processing and settling a payment, and constitutes a supply of service under Section 7 of the CGST Act, 2017. It is classified under financial and related services and is taxed at 18 per cent. GST is not levied for the ₹50,000 paid for a refrigerator; it applies only to the ₹200 MDR fee, resulting in a GST of ₹36. At the cap, the merchant would pay ₹300, along with a GST of ₹54.

During the zero MDR years since January 2020, banks were compensated through a budgetary incentive scheme. On the GST Council’s recommendation, CBIC clarified via Circular No 190/02/2023-GST that these incentives are subsidies directly linked to price, excluded from the value of supply under Section 15.

Two justifications may be offered for the levy: neutrality, on the premise that a service is a service regardless of its nature, and revenue generation, with practitioners estimating it to between ₹3,500 crore to over ₹5,000 crore a year.

The revenue figure is largely illusory. A registered supplier making taxable supplies will claim input tax credit, so the transaction is tax neutral. Net revenue comes only from those who cannot claim credit: the unregistered trader whose UPI receipts exceed ₹1 lakh a month, but whose turnover is below the registration threshold, the composition dealer barred by Section 10 from availing credit, and those making exempt supplies. Thus, the real burden



SMALL MERCHANTS.
Big challenges in store

falls on the small and the exempt — the merchants the ₹2,000 threshold was meant to protect. For them, GST becomes a cost embedded in price, perpetuating the very tax cascading that GST was designed to eliminate, and raises the effective charge to 0.472 per cent. That is a nudge towards cash in trades with single-digit margins. Retailers have warned that MDR alone could reverse hard won digital adoption as the festival season approaches. GST sharpens that risk.

Neutrality is equally unpersuasive because GST law is not neutral here. Notification No 12/2017–Central Tax (Rate) already exempts services by an acquiring bank for settlement of amounts up to ₹2,000 per transaction through payment cards. Relief for small-value digital settlement is already part of the architecture — this should be extended for consistency.

CONTRADICTIONS

When the government paid banks for processing UPI payments, the payment was a non-taxable subsidy. When the merchant pays for the same service, 18 per cent GST applies — this contradiction must be resolved. The state has also designed the MDR. It prescribes and caps the rate, forbids its recovery from consumers, and earmarks 5 per cent of collections for expanding acceptance among small merchants.

In substance, it is a regulated contribution to the upkeep of public digital infrastructure, for which the Budget provides ₹2,000 crore in FY27, against the industry estimates of about ₹20,000 crore in annual running costs. To tax a charge that exists because budgetary support fell short is to negate the effects of the reliefs extended to certain sections with respect to applicability of MDR.

The writer is a chartered accountant



PVS SURYAKUMAR

India’s agricultural journey is one of the country’s great development successes. Foodgrain production increased from 51 million tonnes in 1950-51 to nearly 358 million tonnes in 2024-25. The country now feeds more than a billion people, and exports agricultural commodities to global markets. It is another matter that production could come under stress this kharif owing to El Nino, with 43 per cent of the country facing a rain deficit amid indications of an acreage drop.

GREEN REVOLUTION

Nevertheless, it can be said that output has not posed serious concerns over time. This achievement was built through the efforts of farmers, scientists, policymakers, extension workers, cooperatives and public institutions.

The Green Revolution transformed Indian agriculture and helped secure the nation’s future.

But if agricultural progress is primarily measured by production, why does farmers’ prosperity remain elusive? Why have direct benefit transfers, such as PM-KISAN and State-level income support schemes, become enduring features of agricultural policy? And why do national surveys continue to indicate that a significant proportion of farmers would prefer to leave agriculture?

INCOME SOURCES

The changing composition of farm household income tells its own story. According to the NSS (SAS-77 round), crop cultivation contributes about 37 per cent of household income, while wages account for 40 per cent, with livestock and non-farm activities making up the balance. Rural households increasingly had to diversify their income sources in response to changing economic realities and growing risks.

Yet, the contrast is striking. Foodgrain production has increased nearly seven-fold since Independence, but these gains have not translated into commensurate improvements in farm household incomes.

The challenge before Indian agriculture today is very different from that of the 1960s. Then, the overriding concern was food security. Today, the agenda is broader and more complex: soil health, groundwater depletion, climate resilience, market volatility, nutritional security, farm incomes and the ability of farming to attract the next generation.

Taken together, these trends suggest the need for a fresh assessment of Indian



More crops, but less gains for farmers

GROUND REALITY. India has solved the problem of food production, but the next big challenge is farmers’ prosperity

agriculture — not merely its production performance — but also the institutions, policies and innovation systems that support it.

India possesses one of the world’s largest public agricultural research systems. ICAR and the State Agricultural Universities have generated a vast body of scientific knowledge and released thousands of crop varieties over the decades. Yet, the more important question is: how many of these varieties continue to find widespread acceptance among farmers? How many also remain relevant under increasingly uncertain climatic conditions?

WHY DISTINCTION MATTERS

How many of these varieties are cultivated on a significant scale? Which varieties account for the bulk of cultivated area in major crops? Which continue to be preferred by farmers and why? And how many have demonstrated resilience not merely in research stations, but in farmers’ fields exposed

A variety released is an output; a variety adopted by farmers is an outcome. The distinction matters.

to increasingly erratic weather? After all, a variety released is an output; a variety adopted and sustained by farmers is an outcome. The distinction matters.

These questions are not merely academic. They help us understand where innovation is succeeding, who is driving it, and how its impact should be assessed.

In hybrid vegetable crops, private innovation has achieved notable farmer acceptance. India is one of the world’s largest vegetable producers and imports substantial quantities of vegetable seeds.

This raises important questions about how well our broader innovation system is responding to farmers’ evolving needs and preferences. This is not about public versus private. Rather, it is an opportunity for the public system — with its vast resources — to reflect on what farmers value, and ensure that its innovations remain relevant, resilient and widely adopted.

NEED FOR EVOLUTION

Farmers adopt varieties that satisfy a complex combination of yield, risk, consumer preference, market acceptance, shelf life and profitability. As the challenges facing agriculture evolve, our institutions, policies and innovation systems must evolve with

them. The more relevant questions today are whether they are responding to farmers’ changing needs, anticipating emerging risks and strengthening resilience. Are we adequately preparing agriculture for droughts, floods, heat stress and erratic weather? Are we helping farmers remain productive, profitable and adaptable in a far more uncertain environment?

These questions acquire added significance in an era of climate uncertainty. Agriculture today must contend with droughts, extreme rainfall, rising temperatures, volatile markets and other emerging risks. Production and productivity will remain important, but they may no longer be sufficient measures of success.

It may, therefore, be time to develop composite metrics for the institutions and agencies that shape and support agriculture. Such metrics could track farm incomes, farmer retention, adoption of new technologies, soil health, groundwater sustainability, resilience under climatic stress and the long-term performance of innovations in farmers’ fields.

What gets measured often influences what gets prioritised.

The writer is the former Deputy Managing Director of Nabard. Views are personal

thehindubusinessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

September 18, 2006

GAIL favours market rates for gas pricing

While favouring a transparent mechanism for reaching a decision on pricing of natural gas, GAIL (India) Ltd is of the view that gas should be available for sale on equitable and non-discriminate basis to any buyer who is ready to pay market price. As there are limited sellers and shortage of domestic gas and with a large number of buyers pitching for same gas, the product should be available to buyer who is willing to pay the market price, GAIL has said.

Chidambaram unveils plan for IMF reform

Mr P. Chidambaram, on Sunday unveiled a plan for the reform of International Monetary Fund, even as the institution flagged off voting by its members on a package that New Delhi had objected to. India, Brazil, Argentina and Egypt had issued a joint statement on Saturday calling upon the IMF to shelve its own reform package for now.

C-DOT Alcatel to roll out Wi-Max gear

The C-DOT Alcatel Research and Development Centre in Chennai is all set to roll out the world’s first consumer premise equipment (CPE) for enabling Wi-Max-based broadband services by April 2007. The research centre set up last year to work on Wi-Max technology is planning to roll out 10 million units a year from its manufacturing unit in Chennai. Wi-Max is touted to be a fourth generation technology that offers data speeds higher than 3G services.

Trump backs Warsh, faults ‘hostile’ Fed Board for rate hike

Bloomberg

US President Donald Trump said he still had confidence in Federal Reserve Chairman Kevin Warsh and criticised what he said was a “hostile” board, even after the central bank unanimously defied his calls to lower borrowing costs. “I do, I mean I’m relying on Kevin,” Trump told reporters about his handpicked Fed chief.

His comments came hours after the Federal Open Market Committee voted to raise rates by a quarter percentage point, increasing the benchmark federal funds rate to a range of 3.75 per cent to 4 per cent.

Trump told reporters on Wednesday that he had spoken to Warsh, though he did not say when that conversation took place. The President said he “didn’t try to convince him”, adding “you might as well vote with the board because it’s not going to matter”.

“I said do what you want,” said Trump. “It doesn’t matter because he doesn’t have the votes,” he continued. “No matter how good a job, he’s got a hostile board.”

UNANIMOUS VOTE

Despite Trump’s remarks blaming what he sees as a “very political” board for the rise, the vote to increase rates was unanimous, with all 12 in favour of the move. Trump’s comments suggest he is willing for now to give his handpicked chairman leeway, even as he increases pressure on the central bank to lower borrowing costs. That creates a complicated dynamic for Warsh to navigate going forward, despite Trump asserting at his swearing-in ceremony he wants the chairman to be “totally independent”.

In a social media post earlier Wednesday, Trump said that US rates “should be 1%, or less” because “Our Country is BOOMING with new



US ECONOMY. What’s at stake?

Investment” and has “the Best Credit in the World.”

Driving rates down to Trump’s desired level would require the central bank to make a significant reduction, a move that typically only accompanies a severe economic crisis. Trump, in his post, continued to argue that interest rates have put the US at a competitive disadvantage to other world economies, tying it to the nation’s

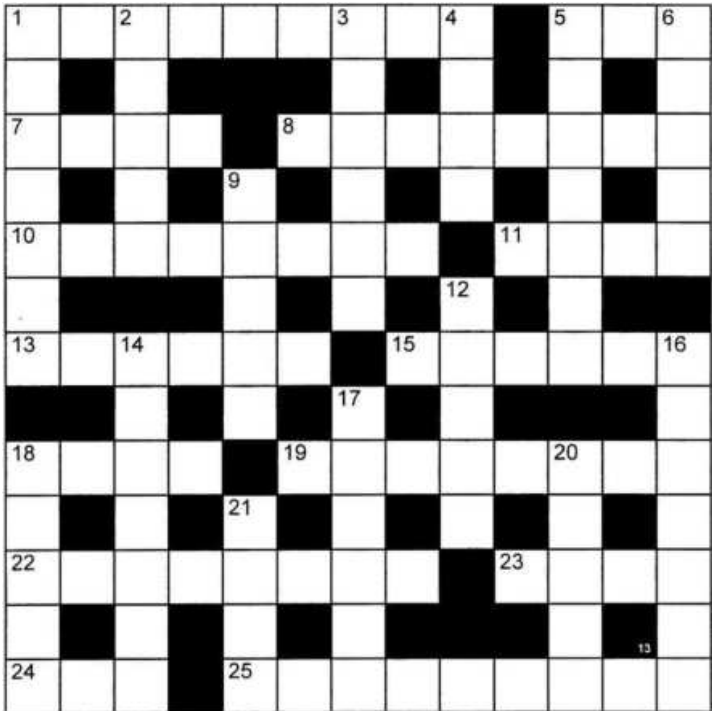
trade deficit by saying: “We are ‘carrying’ almost every country in the world, and that cannot go on any longer.”

‘FALL IN LINE’

In the past, the President has threatened to cut off trade with partners that have a trade surplus, unless the Fed lowered rates. It’s unclear how following through on that threat would lead to lower borrowing costs for Americans.

Wednesday’s rate hike, the first since 2023, came as policymakers lost confidence inflation would cool on its own. The Fed was expected to lift interest rates after recent data showed US consumer prices rising higher than expected in August. Higher energy prices from the US war with Iran — a conflict now in its seventh month — as well as Trump’s tariff policies have clouded the picture for the Fed’s inflation targets.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2738



EASY

ACROSS

- Cutting-off, separation (9)
- Pull along with a rope (3)
- A parent’s sister (4)
- Engine’s firing-system (8)
- Put name forward (8)
- A metropolis (4)
- To reiterate (6)
- Influenced one by strength of mind (6)
- Grain (4)
- (Shaped like) caudal fn (4-4)
- In error (8)
- Extended (4)
- The lot (3)
- Heraldic arms of a deceased person (9)

DOWN

- A wrench (7)
- Snake’s poison (5)
- To nullify (6)
- Wickedness (4)
- Trifling (7)
- Affected by strong breezes (5)
- To work flour into dough (5)
- Be engaged in combat (5)
- A sunshade (7)
- Great pleasure (7)
- Unspeaking (6)
- Punctuation mark (5)
- Sun-dried mud brick construction (5)
- To get money for cheque (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- There’s never case for wriggling out of cut-off pay (9)
- Give one a hitch to the West (3)
- Relative to tease about losing head (4)
- It is turning one gin into method of firing in an engine (8)
- How to name a Tom – nine letters (8)
- It appears, in Cyprus, to be where business is done (4)
- Again say that it’s a second viewing (6)
- It is bequeathed to the French in an uncultivated area (6)
- Old jokes may be an indication of trouble afoot (4)
- It will move side to side as it’s shaped like a swimmer’s rear (4-4)
- Having the wrong idea, could create a stink with me (8)
- Yearn to have more than the average number in a particular suit (4)
- Everything is the same either side on court (3)
- Arms of dead person that men set out around the church (9)

DOWN

- It was a wrench when the pens ran haywire (7)
- It was spite that made me no other way after five (5)
- How to deny the unending teenage revolution (6)
- It may be a misfortune to dwell upside-down (4)
- It could rival it at being unimportant (7)
- Is scared that it’s blowing up outside (5)
- Work at making dough out of necessity, one is told (5)
- Box for gift that might contain heroin (5)
- Father taking solar arrangement that would protect him (7)
- Much pleasure around 3rd August it held, perhaps (7)
- Is up fast, and saying nothing (6)
- A butterfly that may make one pause mid-sentence (5)
- Nothing found in a bed made of sun-dried mud brick (5)
- In short, cent has to be changed for ready money (4)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2737

ACROSS 1. Potent 4. Secret 9. Overdid 10. Tabor 11. Iota 12. Burr 13. Due 15. Drip 16. Bank 19. Ill 21. Pole 22. Scan 24. Inter 25. Courier 26. Yarned 27. Ragged

DOWN 1. Profitability 2. Treated 3. Node 5. External 6. Rabid 7. Three-cornered 8. Odour 14. Disperse 17. Kicking 18. Flock 20. Later 23. Pupa

QUICKLY.

NSE public issue gets bids for 43% on day 1



Chennai: The National Stock Exchange of India's ₹22,569 crore IPO saw a modest demand on the day of issue opening on Thursday, with retail and high net worth individuals showing some interest. At the end of day one, the IPO was subscribed 43 per cent or 0.43 times, receiving bids for 3.84 crore shares against 8.86 crore on offer, exchange data showed. While the HNIs portion saw subscriptions of 0.72 times, the retail window was booked 0.44 times. Employees, however, remained aggressive, as their quota was covered almost fully on day 1 even as QIBs remained muted at 0.19 times. The NSE public issue, priced ₹1,700-1,785, closes on September 21, with a listing planned on September 24. **OUR BUREAU**

A-One Steels to launch ₹405-crore IPO on Sept 24

Mumbai: A-One Steels India Ltd will open its initial public offering for public subscription on September 24, with the bidding window closing on September 28. Anchor investor allocation is scheduled for September 23. The company aims to list on both the BSE and the NSE. The price band has been set at ₹385-₹405 per share, with a minimum bid lot of 37 shares. The total offer size comprises a fresh issue of shares worth up to ₹355 crore and OFS of up to ₹50 crore by promoters Sandeep Kumar, Sunil Jallan and Krishan Kumar Jalan. PL Capital Markets and Khambatta Securities are the book running lead managers, with Bigshare Services as registrar. **OUR BUREAU**

Listing of 6 IPOs: Rentomojo, Karamtara, Steamhouse sizzle

Our Bureau

Six mainboard IPOs debuted on the stock exchanges on Thursday with four stocks — Rentomojo, Karamtara Engineering, LCC Projects, Steamhouse India — listing at a premium to their IPO prices, while Manipal Payment opened at a discount but managed to close 2 per cent higher, and Asset Reconstruction Company (India) made a flat debut and dipped further. LCC Projects posted the highest listing premium at 31.4 per cent on the BSE, but closed a little lower. Karamtara Engineering and Rentomojo settled with significant gains. Ravi Singh, Chief Research Officer at Master Capital Services, said Manipal Payment's weak debut could keep near-term sentiment under pressure, while Asset Reconstruction Company's flat listing may keep investor interest subdued. Shivani Nyati, Head of Wealth at Swastika Investment, said Rentomojo's listing gain had priced in much of the near-term optimism, while ARCIL's flat debut supports a medium-term hold with NPA trends as a key risk. She said Manipal Payment's discounted listing reflects valuation and growth concerns. Steamhouse India's gain leaves limited room for error at its high valuation.

Emami approves ₹282 crore share buyback at maximum price of ₹475

Our Bureau

FMCG maker Emami on Thursday said its board has approved a share buyback of up to ₹282 crore through the open market route at a maximum price of ₹475 per share. In this proposed buyback, the first since 2023, the company will buy back up to around 59.37 lakh shares, representing around 1.36 per

SEBI to examine brokers' concerns over UPI merchant charges

STICKING POINT. Brokers raise concerns over costs on client fund transfers even when no trade takes place

Our Bureau

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) will examine concerns raised by stock brokers over the new merchant discount rate (MDR) on UPI transactions, Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said on Thursday, as the industry has raised concerns on the additional costs that could arise from client fund transfers. "I think there are some important issues there. We will certainly look into it and see how we can ease them," Pandey said on the sidelines of the National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development's (NaBFID) Infrastructure conclave. Under the new frame-

work, capital-market transactions, including payments to stockbrokers, mutual funds, investment advisors and dealers, will attract an MDR of 0.02 per cent, capped at ₹300 per transaction, from October 15. This is lower than the 0.4 per cent MDR applicable to eligible person-to-merchant UPI transactions in other categories. However, recurring standing instructions or UPI mandates, such as those for mutual fund SIPs, will not be charged. **BROKERS CONCERNED** Brokers have approached SEBI raising concerns that the levy could disproportionately increase their costs since money transferred by a client to a broking account



RAISING THE BAR. SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said there is a need to improve creditworthiness, governance, disclosures and predictable project cash flows for expanding the market **ANI**

does not necessarily result in a trade. The BSE Brokers' Forum has also taken up the matter with the regulator. Unlike a conventional merchant payment, funds transferred to a broker are meant for investment or trading and the broker may

earn little or no revenue from the transfer itself. Brokers are mandated by SEBI to return the unused client funds periodically to prevent any misuse of the client float. If clients subsequently transfer the money back to their broking

accounts through UPI, the MDR could be incurred again. Speaking at the NaBFID conclave, Pandey said the regulator is also looking to widen the municipal bond market by allowing more municipalities to raise funds through pooled financing structures, along with bringing more domestic institutional capital, global long-term investors and retail participation into REITs and InvITs. As of March 2026, 22 urban local bodies had raised more than ₹4,500 crore through 31 municipal bond issuances. Pandey said there is a need to improve creditworthiness, governance, disclosures and predictable project cash flows for expanding the market.

Brokerages seek MDR for capital market transactions to be limited to 2 basis points

Jyoti Banthia

Discount brokerage firms, including Groww, Zerodha, Angel One, Upstox and others, have approached the Securities and Exchange Board of India, seeking changes to the proposed framework for merchant discount rate (MDR) on UPI transactions, according to sources privy to the development. The brokers have proposed that MDR for capital market transactions be limited to around 2 basis points, with an absolute transaction fee cap of ₹2-5, sources said. They argued

that such a structure would prevent the additional payment cost from being passed on to customers while keeping the impact manageable for brokers and other participants in the ecosystem. According to industry sources, the proposed ₹300 cap is largely irrelevant for capital market transactions. At an MDR rate of 2 per cent, a ₹300 cap would be reached only at a transaction value of around ₹15 lakh, while UPI transaction limits are around ₹5 lakh for relevant transactions. **20,000 THRESHOLD** The brokers also sought a

significant increase in the threshold below which the MDR is not charged. They want the existing ₹2,000 threshold to be raised to ₹20,000, saying this would better reflect ticket sizes in capital market transactions. The industry pointed to the payment profile of capital market transactions to make its case. Around 80 per cent of the transactions are understood to be lumpsum payments, of which nearly 95 per cent are UPI-driven. Within these UPI transactions, around 70 per cent are above ₹2,000, meaning a significant proportion of capital market payments could become

subject to MDR under the existing threshold. The firms have also flagged the treatment of customer fund movements. At present, brokers could have to bear MDR when customers add funds to their trading accounts through UPI. The industry is additionally seeking exclusion of running-account payouts, under which unused customer funds are returned to the customer. Brokers argue that applying MDR to such payouts could result in them incurring a payment cost even though they have not earned revenue on the funds being returned.

Tata Group stocks jump as board approves Chandra's extension

Anupama Ghosh

Shares across the Tata Group rose sharply on Thursday after the Tata Sons board voted by majority to reappoint N Chandrasekaran as Executive Chairman for a fresh five-year term, a move the majority shareholder, Tata Trusts, immediately contested as a legal nullity. Tata Investment Corporation led the rally, rising 5.47 per cent on the BSE. Tata Chemicals gained 6.6 per cent, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles climbed 4.52 per cent, Tata Motors rose 2.82 per cent, and Tata Steel was up 2.82 per

Markets steady after Fed rate hike; Nifty, Sensex end flat

Anupama Ghosh

The markets held their ground on Thursday even as the US Federal Reserve delivered its first interest rate increase since 2023, raising borrowing costs by 25 basis points and signalling at least one more hike this year, a move that rattled currencies and kept investors on edge across emerging markets. The Nifty 50 closed at 23,270.60, up 53 points, while the Sensex ended marginally lower at 74,314.59, down about 22 points. The Bank Nifty underperformed, declining 237 points to settle at 56,055.75, weighed by weakness in private sector and PSU banks. However, Nifty Midcap 100 gained 0.92 per cent, and the Nifty Smallcap 100 rose 0.76 per cent, outpacing the headline indices. Market breadth was sup-

portive, with 358 stocks from the Nifty 500 universe closing in positive territory. "Domestic markets remained volatile but ended higher, supported by value buying following the recent correction," said Vinod Nair, Head of Research at Geojit Investments. "Investor sentiment is likely to stay cautious amid concerns over a possible broader rate-tightening cycle, driven by ongoing West Asia tensions and the risk of US tariff." Sectoral performance was mixed but tilted green. Pharma, healthcare, realty, auto, media, and metals were among the better performers, each gaining ground. Banking, FMCG, and oil and gas remained under pressure. Looking ahead, the markets are expected to stay range-bound and selective. "Nifty could bounce back to 23,500/75,000," said Shrikant Chouhan, Head of Equity Research at Kotak Securities.

BROKER'S CALL.

JM Financial

GMR AIRPORTS (BUY) Target: ₹115 CMP: ₹95.20 GMR Airports reported soft passenger growth (~1 per cent y-o-y) in Aug'26, which includes the newly added Nagpur and Bhogapuram airports. Excluding this, organic growth declined 2.6 per cent y-o-y. This was largely led by persistent weakness at GHIAL (down 11.5 per cent y-o-y). At key domestic airports, passenger traffic decreased 2.4 per cent y-o-y led by about 4 per cent y-o-y dip in domestic passenger traffic, whereas international traffic rose marginally by 1.4 per cent y-o-y, which in our view indicates non-aero revenues are likely to sustain or improve. We expect weakness in passenger traffic to sustain till Nov'26, largely due to impact of the West Asia crisis. We do expect passenger traffic growth to rebound from Dec'26, largely due to favourable base effect, owing to the IndiGo airline crisis in late-CY25. Hence, growth may get restored in Dec'26 and Jan'27 on favourable base effect. We value the operational airports in India at GMR's long-term average 12-month forward EV EBITDA of 21x to derive our TP of ₹115; maintain BUY. In light of the recent fall in the share price. While softness in share price may continue in the near term due to muted passenger traffic, the headwinds seems to be largely factored in at current price levels, making risk-reward position relatively attractive.

Elara Securities

SOLAR INDUSTRIES (ACCUMULATE) Target: ₹19,970 CMP: ₹18,890 Solar Industries has announced a 100 per cent acquisition of South Africa-listed company Omnia Holdings, a leading fertilizer and mining explosives maker, in an all-cash deal worth ₹13,000 crore. The acquisition would enable Solar Industries to double revenue by FY28E post consolidation. However, it will be margin and ROE dilutive, as Omnia EBITDA margin stood at 11 per cent in FY26 with a ROE at around 13 per cent. Management expects a combined revenue of ₹32,000 crore (Omnia revenue of ₹14,000-15,000 crore) with an EBITDA of ₹6,500 crore, implying margin of 20 per cent, lower than Solar Industries margin of 27 per cent, and combined PAT of ₹3,200-3,500 crore. The acquisition would be funded through internal accruals and debt, which implies an additional debt of ₹11,000 crore, and annual interest cost of ₹800-900 crore. We expect a gradual scale-up in margin for Omnia in the long term, driven by backward and forward integration synergies as witnessed its other AU subsidiaries. We revise our rating to Accumulate and lower our TP to ₹19,970, as we shift to an SOTP method, valuing Solar Industries at 50x (from 65x) September FY28E P/E to ₹18,591 based on lower contribution of the defence space to overall sales and return ratios compressing, due to inclusion of Omnia. The pace of margin scale-up and reduction of debt would be the key monitorables for rating.

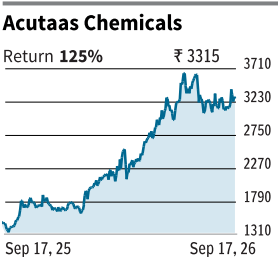
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TODAY'S PICK.

Acutaas Chemicals (₹3,315.60): BUY

Akhil Nallamuthu

bl. research bureau



Acutaas Chemicals' stock reached a record high of ₹3,735 in early July. However, it lost momentum after that. Although it did not reverse the trend, the scrip started to consolidate. The chart shows the formation of a strong base at ₹3,050. The ₹3,000-3,050 price band is support, and as long as this level holds, the uptrend will remain intact. We expect the stock to regain traction soon, surpass the nearest hurdle at ₹3,500 and appreciate to ₹4,000 in the long term. So, participants can go long now at ₹3,315 and buy more shares at ₹3,150. Place a stop-loss at ₹2,900. When the price rises to ₹3,680, move the stop-loss to ₹3,400. On a rally to ₹3,850, raise the stop-loss to ₹3,700. Book profits at ₹4,000. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23350 Nifty 50 Futures				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23200	23100	23400	23500	Go short on the contract at 23380; stop-loss can be 23500.
₹713 HDFC Bank				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
712	700	725	740	Buy if the stock breaks out of 725; place a stop-loss at 710.
₹1056 Infosys				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1030	1000	1080	1100	The stock might see a decline; sell with a stop-loss at 1080.
₹266 ITC				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
262	260	268	270	The stock faces a resistance; go short with stop-loss at 270.
₹232 ONGC				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
230	225	234	238	Trading a key base; buy above 234 with a stop-loss at 231.
₹1240 Reliance Ind.				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1230	1200	1250	1270	Intraday trend appears weak; sell with a stop-loss at 1265.
₹984 SBI				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
970	960	1000	1010	Likely to see a fall; short the stock now with stop-loss at 1000.
₹2196 TCS				
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2160	2140	2225	2250	The stock could witness a fall; sell with a stop-loss at 2235.
S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.				

Nifty 50 Movers ▲ 53.00 pts.				
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Eternal Ltd.	322.35	8.45	718.43	2.19
Tata Steel	187.29	7.75	20.76	1.45
Bharat Elec	395.45	7.59	47.02	1.33
L&T	3836.20	7.29	26.89	4.22
SBI Life	1766.90	6.77	68.15	0.75
HDFC Life	557.00	6.30	60.85	0.56
Tata Motors PV	314.50	6.17	0.00	0.62
Reliance Ind	1243.90	5.76	19.09	7.89
Int'l Globevill	4845.00	5.52	0.00	1.03
Bajaj Finance	1015.50	5.15	30.61	2.55
Maruti Suzuki	12338.00	4.90	27.06	1.51
Shriram Finance Ltd.	995.00	4.90	20.68	1.31
Dr Reddys Lab	1175.00	4.66	30.81	0.67
ITC	266.20	4.32	16.53	2.41
Asian Paints	2454.00	3.70	48.66	1.04
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	229.30	3.20	73.27	0.71
Sun Pharma	1867.30	3.19	36.98	1.86
Bajaj Finserv	1859.20	2.81	14.42	1.01
NTPC	329.60	2.69	11.28	1.47
Hindalco	980.50	2.47	13.44	1.33
Kotak Bank	416.50	2.41	20.41	2.88
Adani Ports	1738.30	2.34	30.52	1.20
Cipla	1376.30	2.25	33.13	0.73
Max Healthcare	1037.00	1.95	69.25	0.72
TataConsumerProduct	1013.70	1.94	61.09	0.62
UltraTech Cement	10764.00	1.65	37.01	1.20
Apollo Hosp	8768.50	1.62	58.05	0.85
Trent Ltd.	2789.00	1.40	81.96	0.87
MMST	3076.50	1.27	18.90	2.58
HCL Tech	1258.30	1.22	39.19	1.25
PowerGrid Corp	263.75	0.94	15.43	1.12
JSW Steel	1253.40	0.92	10.95	1.10
Bharti Airtel	1836.00	0.66	30.72	5.24
Tech Mahindra	1561.00	0.42	29.63	0.93
ICIS	2190.00	0.27	15.83	2.10
Adani Enter	2923.20	0.22	50.26	0.79
Eicher Motors	7493.50	0.20	35.63	0.97
Wipro	166.40	-0.29	12.41	0.42
Axis Bank	1240.00	-0.63	13.80	3.34
Infosys	1058.60	-1.07	14.16	3.49
Grasim Ind	3173.10	-1.15	18.98	1.12
Nestle India	1370.60	-2.18	69.35	0.92
Coal India	418.00	-2.22	8.26	0.94
Bajaj Auto	11500.00	-2.25	27.82	1.20
State Bank	988.70	-2.44	10.18	3.84
ONGC	232.43	-3.71	6.53	0.85
Hind Unilever	1942.20	-3.84	43.49	1.62
Titan	4841.00	-6.09	74.61	1.88
KICV Bank	1347.60	-6.51	16.18	0.07
HDFC Bank	713.00	-28.44	13.31	10.25

Nifty Next 50 Movers ▲ 775.40 pts.				
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Tata Motors Cv	436.10	71.92	38.36	3.72
Divis Lab	9323.00	60.94	84.61	4.84
Cg Power & Ind Sol	880.00	56.69	111.94	2.46
HindustanAeronautics	4788.00	50.94	34.35	3.71
Tvs Motor Cmp	4101.70	46.90	54.11	3.94
Samvardnathersoninternatl	161.87	46.22	37.51	2.92
Adani Power .	205.92	43.17	27.33	3.49
Tata Power	369.00	41.68	22.43	2.51
Adani Energy Solutions .	1386.80	35.88	53.91	1.86
Indian Hotels Co. .	726.65	33.81	44.80	2.61
DIF	640.00	32.07	35.62	1.68
Cummins India	5020.00	31.40	58.79	2.77
Jindal Steel	1128.40	27.34	42.50	1.71
Torrent Pharma	4875.00	26.64	86.01	2.92
Siemens Energy India .	3109.10	24.60	74.41	1.12
Abb India	7130.50	22.95	97.16	1.53
Bpid	307.00	21.50	7.77	2.54
Varun Beverages.	415.45	20.07	41.22	2.32
Zydluslsciences	1135.10	20.07	24.87	1.16
Macrotech Developers .	1103.10	12.66	26.69	1.25
Godrej Consumer	873.00	11.68	46.68	1.43
Gail (India)	172.00	10.58	11.46	1.90
Bajaj Holdings	11010.00	10.07	13.63	0.95
Ltintindtree	4265.30	8.72	24.35	1.62
Hdfc Amc	2387.70	8.65	34.72	1.99
Pidilintind	1551.50	6.93	59.01	1.96
Canara Bank	123.90	6.84	5.67	1.70
Hindus Zinc	572.30	6.71	24.17	1.12
Shree Cement	21960.00	6.41	16.43	1.20
Siemens	3763.50	5.52	92.25	1.36
Bosch	47735.00	4.54	59.58	1.69
Ambuja Cements	383.25	3.99	19.36	0.98
Adanigreenergy	1274.20	3.90	97.80	1.74
Indian Railway Finance Corp	79.31	2.10	14.41	0.65
Hyundai Motor India .	418.47	2.07	35.45	1.26
United Spirits.	1390.00	4.43	59.93	1.68
Tata Capital	343.65	0.22	26.63	0.71
Muthootfin	2770.20	-0.37	9.71	1.21
Union Bank	178.09	-0.62	6.59	1.41
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1764.50	-1.38	26.16	3.12
Punjab Natl Bank	416.47	-3.30	6.05	1.64
AvenueSuper	3711.20	-4.12	79.17	2.44
Power Finance	344.95	-4.44	3.38	2.05
Mazgaon Dock	2210.00	-4.83	31.24	0.69
Indian Oilcorp	134.27	-5.21	5.31	2.05
Britannia Ind.	4982.00	-5.99	45.97	2.40
Solar Industries	18815.00	-6.02	83.04	1.87
Rural Elec	310.60	-7.89	5.19	1.96
Bank Of Baroda	222.30	-14.45	6.53	1.76

LCA delays, engine deals shape HAL's growth roadmap, says CMD Ravi

LOOKING UPBEAT. Company expects strong revenue growth from its ₹2.55 lakh crore order book

bl.interview

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

A day before Central public sector enterprise Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd (HAL) hands over two LCA FOC trainer aircraft, four Dhruv next-generation (NG) helicopters and HTT-40 basic trainer aircraft on Friday, CMD Ravi K spoke about its fiscal health, manpower realignment, the Tejas LCA Mk-1A fighter aircraft delivery delays, engine co-production and other strategic programmes.

Edited excerpts:

Can you tell us why the Tejas LCA Mk-1A fighter aircraft has missed several delivery schedules? As per the 2021 contract, HAL was supposed to start handing over the first batch of 83 Tejas Mk1As from March 2024.

There are a few radar issues and weapon integration is done. There has to be some tests for confirming to standards.

It's only the software change, that's all. But, having said that, when you put a missile, you need to test how the missile or the structure will behave. So, those tests are being done. Otherwise all other tests, including on firing, are complete.

How many GE F404-IN20 engines has HAL received from the US-based GE Aerospace for the LCA Mk-1A jets?
I have received 10 engines and I will be able to deliver these 10 LCA Mk-1As by March. They have promised 12 additional engines by December this year.

Where is the talk headed for collaboration with GE Aerospace for the co-production of 99 F414-INS6 fighter jet engines in India?

All technical issues have been resolved. We are expecting commercial proposal from GE. They told us a long time back that they would need three months to give a proposal. By October, we should get something or they may take one or two months more since it's a big project. We are hoping to get AoN (acceptance of necessity) clearance from the Ministry of Defence so that we can sign the contract.

Talking about the fiscal health of HAL, you have long-term business visibility of around ₹2.55 lakh crore. But how do you plan to meet the challenge of converting the order-book into revenue?

We have put that out in our annual report. You need to see the orders we have of LCA (light combat aircraft Tejas), LCH (light combat helicopter) and ALH (advanced light helicopter). All these programmes are available, which gives us confidence that we should be able to deliver in the next two-three years.

So with this itself, my revenue growth will be very good. Other than that, the ROH (repair and overhaul) and supply of spares will add to the numbers.

Additional orders I get or can get, like the one from Pawan Hans, is a bonus since we did not have this visibility one year ago. We have been able to cover up for the LCA (delay deliveries). We are



We are expecting a commercial proposal from GE. They told us a long time back that they would need three months to give the proposal

RAVI K
CMD, HAL



able to meet the numbers.

For the first two quarters, we have done great.

There are also legacy issues with HAL. How do you intend to sort that out?

Legacy issues in the sense like manpower challenges and bottlenecks. And the government had also set up a committee to look into the functioning of HAL. They're just trying to understand how the company works, whether it's aligned, like other companies, to the businesses in the way it is supposed to be.

On manpower, we very clearly identified core activity and non-core activity, and defined it company-wise and not one division at a time. We want to outsource it in areas they will be able to do it.

So, we are hiring manpower; we need to do the core activity only. Already, we have advertised for a few vacancies this year. Every year I will do it because I need manpower at the end of the day. And we have tied up with so many companies for doing the outsourced jobs. I feel this issue is behind me now, because I have a very clear way forward on how to resolve manpower issue.

Can you update us on

light utility helicopter (LUH) programme?

I have got 12 prototype LUH. The overall requirement is of 187. There are two to three issues of flight control and engine condition on landing since it's a single-engine aircraft. We are fairly confident of resolving these two issues by December. But the helicopter *per se* is really, really very good. I have flown in that and the vibrations are less. Even the cabin space is such that I can put two stretchers in that. No helicopter can accommodate two stretchers. So, I'm seeing a very good market for LUH.

The Indian Multi Role Helicopter (IMRH) project is going on, and there are two things. One is IMRH aircraft design.

We recently signed a contract with Safran for 50-50 joint design development collaboration. Safran will do certain portion of design, and I will also pitch in. We will integrate subsequently, but the manufacturing will be in India.

Secondly, as you know, all platforms start with the engine. So at least we know about the basic engine now. We have started the design of the helicopter engine. So a lot of PDRs (preliminary design reviews) have been computed for the system.

Fortis Healthcare moves SC against Daiichi forensic audit order

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Fortis Healthcare said it has approached the Supreme Court against a forensic audit order passed by the Delhi High Court in the Daiichi Sankyo enforcement proceedings. In a regulatory filing, the healthcare provider informed that it had filed a special leave petition before the court on Wednesday.

The petition challenges the August 31 order delivered by the Delhi High Court in the case, titled 'Daiichi Sankyo Company Ltd vs Malvinder Mohan Singh and Ors'. The Delhi High Court appointed a forensic auditor to examine the transactions of former Fortis promoters Malvinder Mohan Singh and Shivinder Mohan Singh in connivance with Fortis Healthcare, leading to dissipation of shares in connection with a ₹3,500-crore arbitral award passed in favour of Daiichi Sankyo.

Justice Subramonium Prasad said the forensic audit aims to reconstruct the entire chain of events, enabling the court to identify the persons and firms involved in the dissipation of shares. It appointed S Ramanand Aiyar and Co as the forensic auditor to conduct the audit and complete it within six months.

OIL plans ₹15,000 cr capex for deepwater exploration

Our Bureau
New Delhi



Ranjit Rath, Chairman, OIL

Oil India (OIL) Chairman Ranjit Rath said the State-run E&P company will spend ₹15,000 crore over the next three years to step up exploration in offshore deep and ultra-deep blocks.

It has a presence across multiple onshore and offshore sedimentary basins across the Andaman, Krishna-Godavari, Mahanadi and Kerala-Konkan basins. Its exploration footprint exceeds 1 lakh sq km.

"We had acquired 48,000 sq km in the deep and ultra deepwater, two blocks in KG Basin and two blocks in Mahanadi basin, for which we have already completed 2D and 3D seismic. As we speak, data processing is underway and while we are processing the acquired data, we are also reprocessing the vintage data that is available. Our idea is that we will be able to avail the benefits from the Samudra Manthan scheme," Rath said at a briefing after OIL's AGM.

By undertaking drilling, OIL is identifying potential blocks. As a matter of preparedness, the company has created a capex of roughly ₹15,000 crore to be spent over three years, he added.

Outlining growth priorities for the E&P company, Rath said the focus is on higher domestic oil and gas

production, accelerated exploration including deep- and ultra-deepwater opportunities, strengthening its integrated energy value chain and selective expansion in clean energy.

The Samudra Manthan scheme and the GOBARdhan scheme provide significant policy impetus to two areas in which OIL is building its future capabilities.

OIL's expanding offshore programme is closely aligned with Samudra Manthan. In the Andaman basin, Sri Vijayapuram-2 block established a natural gas occurrence, while Sri Vijayapuram-3 resulted in a gas discovery with continuous flaring, providing encouraging evidence of an active petroleum system in this frontier basin.

The expansion of Numaligarh Refinery from 3 mtpa to 9 mtpa progressed during the year, while the augmentation of the Numaligarh-Siliguri Product Pipeline from 1.72 mtpa to 5.5 mtpa was completed, strengthening energy infrastructure in the North-East.

AHMEDABAD MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

LIGHT DEPARTMENT - TENDER NOTICE

AMC invites sealed competitive bids from interested Bidders for the below mentioned work:

IMPLEMENTATION OF 75 MW (AC) GRID-CONNECTED GROUND-MOUNTED SOLAR PV POWER PROJECT ALONG WITH 7.5 MW / 30 MWh BATTERY ENERGY STORAGE SYSTEM (BESS) UNDER GROUP CAPTIVE MODE FOR AHMEDABAD MUNICIPAL CORPORATION (AMC) IN THE STATE OF GUJARAT.

Online Submission up to	Date : 09/10/2026 Only up to 04:00 PM.
Last Date of Submission of (Hardcopy)	Date : 14/10/2026 up to 04:00 PM.
Tender details available on	https://tender.nprocure.com

भारतीय बागान प्रबन्ध संस्थान बेंगलुरु

INDIAN INSTITUTE OF PLANTATION MANAGEMENT BENGALURU

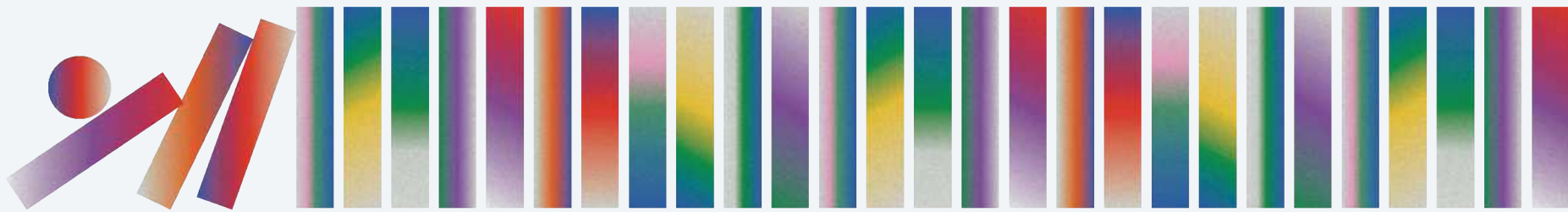
(An Autonomous Organization of the Ministry of Commerce & Industry, GOI)

WALK-IN INTERVIEW (Urgent Requirement)

Position: Assistant Professor (Economics) – On contractual.
Qualification: Ph.D. in Economics with a Post-Graduate Degree in Economics obtained through regular mode from a recognized University/Institution.
Eligibility Criteria & Others: Candidates are required to fulfill the detailed eligibility criteria prescribed in the recruitment notification published on the Institute website.
Walk-in Interview: 29th September 2026 (Tuesday), 10:00 AM
For detailed eligibility criteria, visit: www.iipmb.edu.in
Venue: Indian Institute of Plantation Management (IIPM), Jnana Bharathi Campus, Bengaluru – 560056.
Date: 18.09.2026
Notification: 07/2026

Sd/-
DIRECTOR

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CHIEF GUEST

Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman
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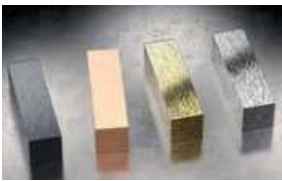
QUICKLY.

Gold shines on weaker dollar, easing oil prices



Gold gained more than two per cent on Thursday, rebounding from the previous session's near six-week low, supported by easing oil prices and a lower US dollar, while investors assessed the latest Federal Reserve rate hike and policy cues. Spot gold was up 2.4 per cent at \$4,364.29 per ounce, as of 1311 GMT. US gold futures for December delivery rose 0.4 per cent to \$4,404.80. The Fed raised rates on Wednesday and flagged more hikes in the coming months. Silver rose 3.9 per cent to \$65.44; platinum gained 2.1 per cent to \$1,787.68 and palladium climbed 2.2 per cent to \$1,296.86. REUTERS

Copper rallies as Chinese buyers return



London: Copper prices rallied as Chinese buyers returned to the market after a recent sell-off, while demand prospects brightened and the dollar softened. Benchmark copper on the LME was up 1.6 per cent at \$14,456 a tonne at 1328 GMT. Prices of the metal have dropped around four per cent since hitting a record high of \$14,875 on September 10. Zinc climbed 1.9 per cent to \$3,884, aluminium rose 0.5 per cent to \$3,285 and lead edged up to \$1,905. Tin advanced 1.2 per cent to \$53,055 and nickel added 1.1 per cent to \$16,350. REUTERS

Basmati rice acreage declines, production poised to fall

EXPORTS TO GAIN. Dip in area, firm global prices brighten prospects for aromatic rice

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Basmati rice production in the country is likely to fall this year as acreage is estimated to have declined nearly 4 per cent, mainly in western Uttar Pradesh and Haryana. This could help exporters seek better prices from overseas buyers amid the ongoing tensions in West Asia, a key market for Indian aromatic rice. Last year, domestic production was about 10 million tonnes (mt). According to industry sources, the acreage under basmati is about 1 lakh hectares (lh) lower than the 24.9 lh recorded in 2025. The only positive aspect is that acreage in Punjab remains unchanged from last year, sources said, adding that production in the State may also be higher as the crop was



BULLISH OUTLOOK. A second consecutive year of decline in basmati acreage is likely to support prices this year

damaged by floods last year. However, with basmati acreage estimated about 27.5 lh in 2024, the second consecutive year of decline in area is likely to support prices this year. Overall rice (both basmati and non-basmati) acreage in Madhya Pradesh was 1.75 lh lower year-on-year as of September 4. In the 2025 kharif season, rice acreage stood at 42.10 lh in the State, official data show. Industry estimates put basmati acreage at 6-7 lh in Madhya Pradesh, with the

entire decline in rice acreage this year estimated to be in basmati. In 2025-26, India exported 6.52 mt of basmati rice worth \$5.67 billion, with an average realisation of nearly \$870 a tonne. During April-June of the current fiscal, exports were 1.54 mt, valued at \$1.44 billion, with value realisation at about \$938, per Apeda data.

PRICES UP In Karnal, Haryana, farmers have started bringing the Pusa 1509 variety, which arrives early because of its shorter duration and is currently selling at ₹3,950 a quintal. Traders said basmati from both Karnal and neighbouring Shamli district in Uttar Pradesh is seeing good demand, as acreage under the premium Pusa 1121 variety is said to be lower and prices are expected to rise further.

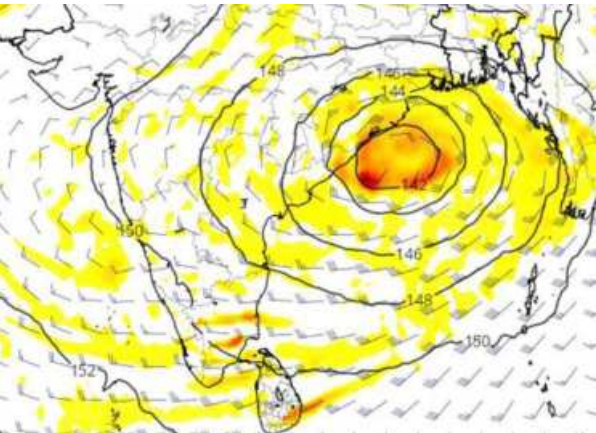
TN, Puducherry, Keralam to witness rainy weekend as ‘low’ brews

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

A cyclonic circulation over north Thailand persisted on Thursday morning and is likely to emerge over the north Andaman Sea on Friday before descending to lower atmospheric levels and setting up a fresh low pressure area by Saturday evening, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said. It is likely to intensify gradually and move west-northwest wards towards the south Odisha-north Andhra Pradesh coasts over the next 3-4 days into early next week. IMD's numerical model

predictions have consistently pointed to intensification into a strong weather system, with the European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts (ECMWF) now appearing to support this view.

BAY IN ACTIVE MODE The US Climate Prediction Centre said there is a possibility of increased activity over the Bay next week, with above-normal rainfall expected in association with the possible tropical storm activity. The Joint Typhoon Warning Centre found no other system of note, except tropical storm *Dujan* over the central Pacific, which is likely to be driven away from



WHAT'S BREWING. The IMD has retained its heavy rain watch for the South as the Bay warms up for renewed activity

the Japanese coast. Myanmar's Department of Meteorology and Hydrology is

GI-tagged Mushkbudji rice gains ground in Kashmir

Gulzar Bhat
Anantnag

Once pushed to the margins of Kashmir's paddy fields, the traditional aromatic rice variety Mushkbudji is now emerging as a high-value crop, with cultivation expanding to more than 400 hectares in Sagam and adjoining areas of Anantnag district. Farmers are fetching up to ₹25,000 a quintal for the variety.

DECLINE TO REVIVAL Mushkbudji began disappearing from Kashmir's paddy fields in the 1960s as farmers increasingly shifted to high-yielding rice varieties. Its cultivation declined further over the following decades, while repeated outbreaks of rice blast disease made the traditional variety more difficult and costly to grow. Researchers at the Sher-e-Kashmir University of Agri-

cultural Sciences and Technology-Kashmir (SKUAST-K) subsequently began efforts to revive the variety, developing disease-resistant lines that helped bring Mushkbudji back into cultivation. The revival has now entered a new phase, with the rice gaining commercial traction. Mushkbudji currently sells for around ₹20,000-25,000 a quintal, adding to its appeal as a premium agricultural product. The variety received a Geographical Indication (GI) tag in 2023, formally recognising its regional identity and traditional characteristics. The short-grained, aromatic rice is particularly valued for its distinctive taste and its role in Kashmir's traditional cuisine. Farmers in Sagam and adjoining areas, however, say the popularity of Mushkbudji needs to be accompanied by measures to protect its

identity and purity. They want its cultivation to remain restricted to the GI-designated area, warning that mixing it with other varieties could dilute its distinct characteristics. "The rice should be cultivated in a limited area only. Beyond that, it is being mixed with other varieties, thus losing its identity," said Mohammad Amin, a farmer from Sagam. **PROCESSING FACILITY** Farmers also sought better post-harvest infrastructure, particularly a modern rice mill that can undertake scientific grading and processing. Najeeb-ul-Rehman Sofi, Associate Director Research at the Mountain Research Centre for Field Crops, Khudwani, said Mushkbudji was acquiring a reputation as a cash crop in the Valley because of its market value. "The rice variety has the potential to be exported," Sofi said.

High freight costs weigh on poultry exports; shippers seek govt support

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru



Poultry exports, which came to a standstill during April-May due to the war in West Asia, are gradually recovering, even as the abnormally high freight rates squeeze exporters' margins. Increased competition from Turkiye in the region has added to exporters' concerns. "Demand is currently mixed, and exporters do not see any significant growth yet, though the market is showing signs of recovery," said Valsan Parameswaran, Secretary, All India Poultry Product Exporters Association. Shipping services were disrupted by the war, bringing exports almost to a

standstill in April. Around 120-125 containers were stuck but were cleared by the end of May or early June. Exports gradually recovered to about 25-30 per cent of normal levels in June and July. They have since risen by about 10 percentage points each month and are now at around 50-55 per cent of normal levels, he said. "Exporters are not in a

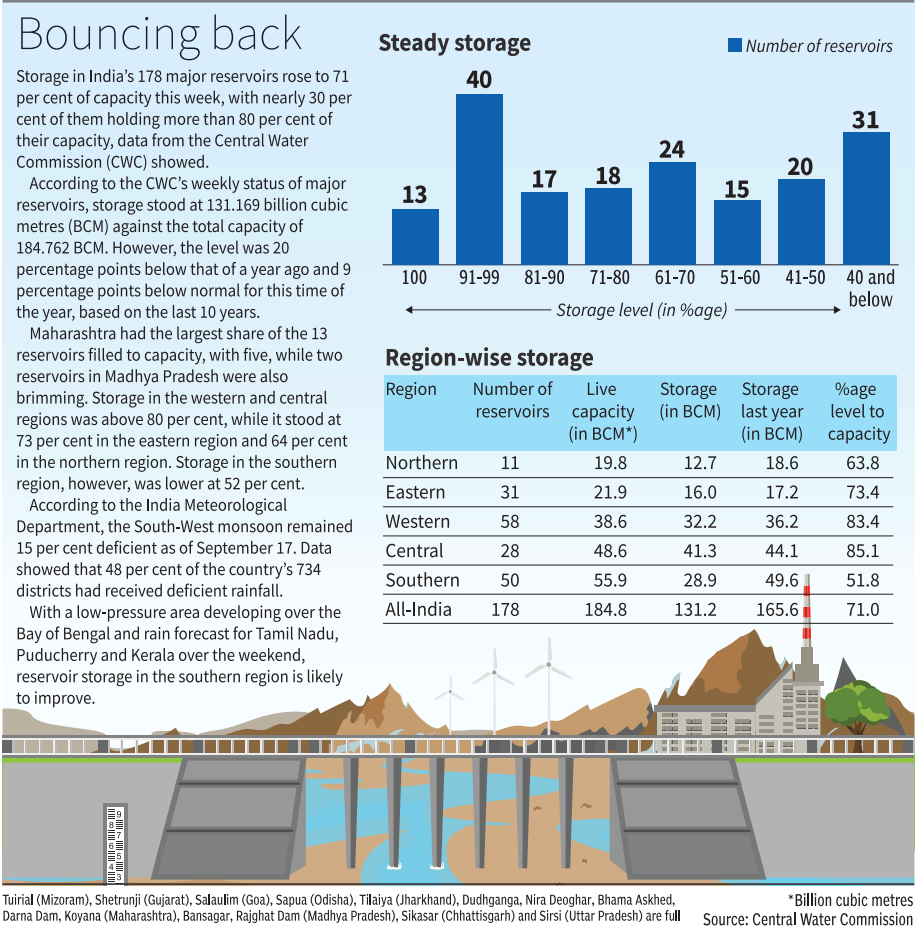
comfortable situation as freight rates have increased more than four-fold. Shipping costs from India to the UAE have risen from around \$1,900 per container to around \$9,000 currently. We request the government to intervene and initiate a dialogue with the shipping lines to bring down costs and increase sailings. We also urge the government to provide some subsidy to offset the high freight costs," Parameswaran added. Further, he said, exporters, despite absorbing losses arising from the high freight rates, were maintaining shipments to keep the trade chain intact, maintain cash flows, keep infrastructure and the workforce operational, and protect market share. The UAE is the biggest

market for Indian poultry products, mainly eggs. **SUSTAINING SHIPMENTS** "Sustaining exports also supports domestic demand and prices, which can have a positive impact on the broader market," Parameswaran said, adding that the Namakkal-Erode region in Tamil Nadu is the country's major egg-exporting hub, accounting for about 99 per cent of shipments. There are about 11-12 approved compartment farms in the Namakkal region, producing eggs for the export market. Some compartment farms in Odisha have also received approval, but logistics remain a challenge, he said. Overall egg exports were estimated around ₹2,000 crore last year, Parameswaran said.

IGC trims 2026-27 world corn crop forecasts

Reuters
London

The International Grains Council (IGC) said on Thursday it had trimmed its forecast for 2026-27 global corn production with crop outlooks reduced for the US, the EU and India. In its monthly update, the inter-governmental body downgraded its forecast for 2026-27 by 4 million tonnes (mt) to 1.301 billion tonnes. The US corn crop was projected to total 401.3 mt, down from a previous forecast of 406.7 mt and well below the prior season's 432.2 mt. The IGC also pared its forecast for the EU corn crop to 46.4 mt (48.5 mt) and India's output to 50 mt (52 mt).



CropLife bats for 5-year data protection regime to bring new pesticides

Our Bureau
New Delhi

CropLife India has urged the Centre to introduce a five-year Regulatory Data Protection (RDP) regime for crop protection products, arguing that it would encourage companies to bring newer molecules to India and widen the range of pest control options available to farmers. The industry body, representing 17 research-driven crop protection companies, said Indian farmers currently have access to about 380 active ingredients (AIs), against around 1,200 available globally. Restrictions on existing pesticides without ensuring availability of better alternatives could hurt farmers, it said in a statement on Thursday. CropLife suggested a two-pronged approach, under which restrictions on exist-

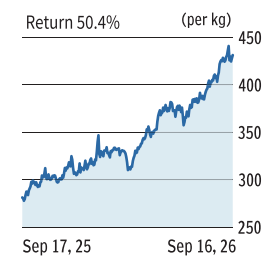
ing molecules should be based on established scientific literature and contextual safety, health and efficacy data, while also assessing the likely impact on farmers. At the same time, it sought five-year protection for regulatory data generated by companies for registering new products in India. Such protection would incentivise investment in studies required under Indian conditions and facilitate faster introduction of newer technologies, it said. **OTHER NATIONS** CropLife said several countries already provide regulatory data protection, ranging from six years in China, Indonesia and Malaysia to as much as 10 years in the US, European Union, Canada, Thailand, Brazil and Colombia. "Factors such as El Nino and climate change are mak-

ing pest pressures even more dynamic and troublesome for farmers," said Rahul Dhanuka, MD, Dhanuka Agri-tech. Mohan Babu Boppana, Vice-Chairman, CropLife India, and COO, Bayer CropScience, said time-bound data protection could encourage innovation and fair competition. Newer molecules, including so-called green molecules, tend to be more selective and require lower application doses, which could reduce their environmental impact, he said. The association estimated that pests and diseases cause annual crop losses of 10-35 per cent in India, valued at about ₹2 lakh crore. CropLife also said access to newer crop-protection technologies was becoming important for agricultural exports as markets such as the EU tighten maximum residue limits for pesticides.

Zinc futures: Stay on the sidelines for now

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Zinc futures (₹423/kg) have rebounded from support, keeping the broader uptrend intact. However, the easing upward momentum suggests that the contract could consolidate before its next directional move. **COMMODITY CALL.** The September contract hit a high of ₹429.95 last week before retreating to ₹408.20 on September 15. It has since recovered to ₹423. The rebound reinforces support around ₹410, which coincides with the 21-day moving average. While the loss of momentum does not necessarily signal a bearish reversal, it raises the likelihood of side-



ways trading. In the near term, the contract could fluctuate between ₹410 and ₹430. A break out of this range is likely to determine the next leg of the trend. A breakout above ₹430 could trigger a rally to ₹450, while a decisive break below ₹410 could drag the contract down to ₹395. **TRADE STRATEGY** Stay on the sidelines for now. Traders can consider fresh positions in the direction of a decisive break out of the ₹410-₹430 range.

Crude oil extends losses as fears of West Asian supply disruption ease

Reuters

Crude oil prices eased on Thursday, extending losses on reports of Saudi Arabia offering extra cargoes through Oman, which reduced fears of supply disruptions, but stayed above \$100 on concerns about the conflict expanding in West Asia. Brent crude futures dropped \$1.88 to \$103.95 a barrel by 0632 GMT, while US West Texas Intermediate futures were down \$1.77 at \$100.66. Both contracts fell about \$3 on Wednesday. "Concerns over supply tightness eased slightly following news that Saudi Arabia would ship cargo via Oman," said Hiroyuki Kikukawa, Chief Strategist of Nissan Securities Investment, a unit of Nissan Secur-



ities. "Expectations of progress toward easing tensions in West Asia ahead of the US-China summit next week are also capping price gains," he added. **BEARISH SIGNALS** Saudi Arabia is offering more loadings of crude oil to Asian refiners via ship-to-ship transfers off Oman's Sohar port, people familiar with the

matter said, blunting some of the hit to global supply from attacks on Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline to the Red Sea. However, some analysts were expecting these flows to only ease a portion of the supply loss from the kingdom's Red Seaport, capping the declines in oil prices. The pick-up in flows through the Strait of Hormuz "is only partly offsetting lost export barrels following drone attacks that shut Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline," Saxo Bank analysts said in a note. Crude oil prices rose to about four-month highs earlier this week. Singapore's DBS Bank assumes in its base-case scenario for the fourth quarter that the US war with Iran will dial down and Brent will stabilise in the \$85 to \$95 range.

QUICKLY.

AITUC slams EPFO's ₹25,000 wage ceiling

New Delhi: The AITUC on Thursday criticised the government's decision to revise the monthly wage ceiling for coverage under EPFO's social security schemes to ₹25,000, saying the hike is "too little and too late". The All India Trade Union Congress said the ceiling should be raised to ₹30,000 to include deserving sections, a statement said. [PH](#)

BIS to upgrade labs across cotton-producing States



Mumbai: The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) on Thursday announced a ₹38.72-crore project to modernise and upgrade 21 laboratories across key cotton-producing States. The BIS is providing direct financial support to establish high-precision testing facilities in critical regional nodes, according to an official statement. These laboratories are geographically distributed across the northern, central, southern and eastern zones. [PH](#)

2-day meet of State FMs starts today in Delhi

New Delhi: The Finance Ministry will organise a two-day conference with Finance Ministers and Secretaries of the States and Union Territories here on September 18-19 to deliberate policy priorities for India's journey towards Viksit Bharat. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman will attend the conference. [PH](#)

Vinsmera Jewels eyes pan-India ramp up with 40 new outlets by 2031

V Sajeew Kumar

Kochi

Kannur-based Vinsmera Jewels plans to open 40 retail outlets across South India over the next five years. Established in 2008, Vinsmera has outlets in Kozhikode and Kochi and is looking at opening outlets in Thiruvananthapuram and Kannur.

The group also aims to expand its five branches across Abu Dhabi, Dubai and Sharjah and scale up manufacturing and wholesale facilities in the UAE.

"The expansion will be backed by a dedicated investment strategy aimed at establishing the brand in new markets across Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh and Telangana, with the objective of pursuing an IPO once this expansion phase is complete," said Dinesh Kambrath, Chairman of Vinsmera Group. "Reimagining jewellery

Coal Ministry offers 25 blocks in 16th round of commercial mine auctions

CRUCIAL PROCESS. Minister urges industry to actively participate to strengthen the country's energy security

Our Bureau

New Delhi

The Coal Ministry on Thursday launched the 16th round of commercial auctions offering 25 blocks — 21 fully explored and four partially explored mines — across nine coal-bearing States.

Launching the auction, Minister of State for Coal and Mines Satish Chandra Dubey highlighted coal's vital role in powering India's growth, meeting around 55 per cent of the country's primary energy requirement and over 70 per cent of its electricity generation.

The round offers coal blocks across Arunachal Pradesh, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Odisha, Telangana and West Bengal.

Of these, six mines are offered under the Coal Mines (Special Provisions)



AUCTIONED AREAS. The latest round offers coal blocks across nine States [REUTERS](#)

Act (CMSP) and 19 under the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act (MMDR).

ALLOCATION NORMS

The blocks are open to experienced mining companies, new entrants and technology-driven enterprises under the liberal commercial coal mining framework, which provides for no end-use restrictions, 100 per cent FDI through the automatic

route and low upfront payments adjustable against future revenue share.

So far, a total of 147 coal mines have been auctioned to date, with cumulative expected annual revenue of over ₹47,500 crore and projected capital investment of more than ₹55,000 crore across the nine States.

The Minister emphasised the importance of providing a level playing field for stakeholders and creating a con-

ducive environment for investment and wider participation in commercial coal mining.

He also underscored the need to unlock India's domestic coal resources, enhance production and reduce dependence on imports, while ensuring efficient and sustainable utilisation of the country's coal reserves. He called upon stakeholders to actively participate in the commercial coal mine auction process and contribute to strengthening India's energy security.

DEVELOPMENT DEALS

On the occasion, Dubey also handed over Coal Mine Development and Production Agreements (CMDPAs) to the successful bidders of six coal mines auctioned in earlier rounds. The agreements covered Tara (Revised), Margo West, Margo East, Mandla South, Dongeri

Tal-II and Dip Side of PKoC.

The six mines together have geological reserves of approximately 1,504 million tonnes and a combined Peak Rated Capacity of 11.62 mt per annum.

They are expected to generate annual revenue of around ₹1,984 crore, attract capital investment of nearly ₹1,743 crore and create around 15,700 employment opportunities.

Captive and commercial mines account for about 21 per cent of the total domestic coal production, which stood at 1,039 mt in FY26.

Nine captive and commercial mines are expected to commence production during FY27, with a combined peak rated capacity of 20.67 mt. Three of these, with peak capacity of 7.51 mt, have started production. Production from captive mines is expected to cross 190 mt in the current financial year.

SC urges govt to put off 3-language policy for Class 6 to Jan 1, 2027

Krishnadas Rajagopal

New Delhi

The Supreme Court urged the Union government on Thursday to make the three-language policy mandatory for Class 6 from January 1, 2027, rather than "springing a surprise" on the current batch when there is hardly four months left for the year to end. The three-judge Bench, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, was reacting to the Centre's reluctance to change its posi-

tion to start the policy with the current batch of Class 6.

Justice Joyimalya Bagchi, on the Bench with Justice V Mohana, said the court's suggestion to delay the policy implementation in Class 6 was made on the basis of logistics and balance of convenience.

Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, appearing for the Centre, agreed to take the suggestion to the government for reconsideration of its position on the issue. "We are not standing in the way. We are only saying

that instead of springing a surprise on this batch of students, start from the first of January... We are not on a point of law, but on a point of comfort. You can start with children who come into January 1, 2027. It is only four months more," Justice Bagchi reasoned.

Chief Justice Kant said the government could use the time to come up with incentives for the children to embrace the study of a third language in school. "The only incentive for them would be to go and play rather than

learn a language," Justice Bagchi quipped.

The judge said the policy was envisaged in 2020. "Push it to 2027 so that everyone comes to terms with the scheme," Justice Bagchi said.

Taking up on the CJT's suggestion, Justice Mohana said the new language could be taught in a lively and engaging manner that would naturally pique the interest of the children. Language, Justice Mohana indicated, should be learnt in an organic manner. Initially, Bhati submitted that the policy

should start with Class 6 this year itself. "We have already given relaxation to Classes 7 to 10. The present Class 6 would face the Board exam only after four years," she submitted.

But the Bench held its ground with Justice Bagchi responding, "Class 7 will face the Board exam only after three years, so? Just because you have stated that Class 6 should be included, it should be included? Give some breathing space". "It is a good policy, but stagger it more," Justice Mohana said.

Will cut NEET-SS qualifying percentile to 30, govt tells apex court

Krishnadas Rajagopal

New Delhi



The Centre on Thursday agreed to reduce the qualifying score for National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test-Super Speciality seats (NEET-SS) from the existing 50th percentile to 30 even as it agreed to return to Tamil Nadu the 40 vacant in-service seats.

"The matter has since been reconsidered in consultation with the concerned stakeholders. In order to ensure that the available super speciality seats do not remain vacant and that the available training capacity is optimally utilised, it has been decided that the qualifying percentile for NEET-SS may be reduced from the existing 50th percentile to 30th percentile for the purpose of the proposed Special Stray Vacancy Round," a Union government note, filed before a Bench headed by Justice PS Narasimha, said.

Consequently, candidates securing 30th percentile and above in NEET-SS would become eligible to participate in the special stray vacancy round for the NEET-SS seats. The State was represented by senior advocate AM Singhvi, Tamil Nadu Additional Advocate General Prashanto Chandra Sen and advocate Rupali Samuel.

The petitioner, Tamil Nadu Medical Officers Association, was represented by senior advocate P Wilson, who sought a zero cut-off percentile reduction as done in the past two years.

SEATS VACANT

In fact, the Centre's note said 1,857 super specialty seats were presently lying vacant pursuant to completion of the second round of NEET-SS counselling.

Further, the Centre submitted, "In the peculiar circumstances, the 40 vacant in-service seats pertaining to Tamil Nadu would be reverted to the State government for the limited purpose of enabling the State to conduct and complete its own stray vacancy round for a period of one week."

In the previous hearing, both the State and Wilson urged the court to intervene, with the Centre for the return of these "precious" 40 seats, noting that they would ensure more in-service government doctors serving in rural parts of the State would get specialised medical training to serve society. The court also gave Tamil Nadu leeway to allow NEET-SS candidates upgradation during the one-week special stray vacancy round.

The Centre, represented by Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, said the reduction of the qualifying percentile in NEET-SS would broaden the candidate pool to approximately 6,000 against a mere 1,857 vacant seats. "Accordingly, the vacant seats may be offered only to candidates who have not joined a seat in the earlier rounds of NEET-SS counselling and who become eligible consequent upon the reduction of the qualifying percentile," the note said.

The Bench listed the case after three weeks following the completion of the counselling process by the State of Tamil Nadu.

SC asks TN to drop anti-Hindi 'mindset'

Krishnadas Rajagopal

New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Thursday said Tamil Nadu has to change the "mindset" that Hindi cannot be taught in the soil of the State, cautioning that "individual States cannot act like individual countries".

The oral observations from Justice BV Nagarathna came in a nearly hour-long hearing on the adoption of the Navodaya Vidyalaya Scheme in Tamil Nadu. The court gave Tamil Nadu three months to comply with a December 15, 2025, order to identify requisite land for Navodaya schools in each district.

It said the direction would be subject to final orders passed later on. In the interim, the State and Central representatives were asked to discuss the policy of establishing Navodaya schools in Tamil Nadu.

GIVE AND TAKE

"Chennai should not alienate Delhi and vice versa," said Justice Nagarathna, heading a Bench comprising Justice AG Masihi.

The Tamil Nadu government had opposed the scheme as "fundamentally incompatible" with the two-language policy followed by the State.

The previous Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam government, in an affidavit filed in March this year, had said that the scheme, which was based on a three-language formula Navodaya scheme, deviated from the mandate of the Tamil Nadu Tamil Learning Act, 2006.

The affidavit had alleged that the imposition of the scheme was only a "backdoor" ploy to make Hindi compulsory.

On Thursday, the now ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam government in the State also objected to the scheme, saying the choice of language is a fundamental right. The court scheduled the next hearing on December 14.

Greenbase to expand in Chennai with ₹2,000 cr investment in industrial parks

Our Bureau

Chennai

Greenbase, the industrial and logistics parks platform of the Hiranandani Group, plans to invest around ₹2,000 crore in 2-3 years to develop five million sq ft of industrial and warehousing space in Chennai as part of its second phase of expansion.

It is developing a 55-acre park at Arani, near Red Hills, to the north of Chennai, with about 1.2 m sq ft of space, with an anchor client identified in the renewable energy space. Land acquisition and approvals have been completed. "Greenbase expects to complete the park in about two years," N Shridhar, CEO, Greenbase Industrial & Logistics Park, said.

GREENBASE 2.0

Across India, its Greenbase 2.0 programme envisages developing around 9-10 m sq ft at a total investment of ₹3,400 crore, of which about



N Shridhar, CEO, Greenbase Industrial & Logistics Park [BUJOY GHOSH](#)

5 m sq ft is already blocked and under development, while the balance is under acquisition, said Shridhar, adding 50-60 per cent of the development is in Chennai.

Its overall plan covers around 430 acres, of which about 215 acres have already been acquired and are under approvals. Another 140 acres are being acquired across three locations near Chennai, while around 100 acres is being pursued in Maharashtra, he said.

Greenbase is also evaluating

Greenbase is also evaluating Coimbatore, Thoothukudi and Hosur for development

Thoothukudi and Hosur for development in Tamil Nadu, he said.

Greenbase 1.0 was developed in joint venture with private equity firm Blackstone Inc. However, Greenbase 2.0 is being developed by the Hiranandani Group.

The Arani project, which is nearly 30 km from the Katupalli port in North Chennai, is expected to cater to industrial and manufacturing clients, with the company in discussions with customers in the renewable energy and recycling sectors.

Another 160-acre park at Palur is also under development, with the first phase targeted for completion within two years.

Apple charts two freighters to fly iPhones from Chennai to US

T E Raja Simhan

Chennai

Tech giant Apple has chartered two dedicated freighter aircraft to ferry more than 200 tonnes of iPhones from Chennai to the US. Sources in the know said two Qatar Airways Boeing 747 freighters — one carrying 100 tonnes and the other 104 tonnes of shipments of Apple iPhones — departed from Chennai to Chicago last week.

While the sources could not identify the models of the phones, electronics industry sources said that Apple is making the new iPhone 18 Pro models in India, more specifically at the Foxconn and Tata Electronics units.

In April 2025, Apple had chartered cargo flights to transport about 600 tonnes of iPhones from India to the US. According to a *Reuters* report at the time, the shipments were estimated to comprise as many as 1.5 million iPhones.

businessline has learnt that despite the congestion, the iPhone consignments were cleared through the green channel at a fast pace by AAI Cargo Logistics and Allied Services Company Ltd, a 100 per cent subsidiary of the Airports Authority of India.

The movement of more than 200 tonnes of iPhones underscores the scale of Apple's air cargo operations from Chennai, which has emerged as an important export point for the company's India-made devices.

'MSMEs must be energy efficient for competitiveness'

Our Bureau

Hyderabad

India's next phase of energy transition will require faster electrification and wider adoption of clean technologies, digital solutions and energy-efficiency measures, with MSMEs needing to significantly accelerate adoption, Krushna Chandra Panigrahy, Director General, Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE), said.

Speaking at the 25th edition of the CII Energy Efficiency Summit 2026 here on Thursday, he said energy efficiency and electrification would be central to meeting rising energy demand while ensuring energy remained affordable and reliable. While large industries had



Krushna Chandra Panigrahy, Director General, BEE

made significant progress in energy efficiency, MSMEs continued to face barriers relating to technical capabilities, financing and operating costs, he said. The ADEETIE scheme could help address some of these constraints, he added. "Energy efficiency should not be seen as a compliance requirement, but as a pathway to global competitiveness," Panigrahy said.

Tejpreet Singh Chopra, Chairman, CII Energy Effi-

ciency Summit 2026 and Founder & CEO, BLP-Industry.AI, said AI and digital tools could accelerate energy-efficiency adoption by shortening the gap between identifying inefficiencies and taking corrective action.

AI could make energy-efficiency insights more accessible and actionable for MSMEs, helping them identify inefficiencies, optimise processes and take data-driven decisions despite having limited technical teams, Chopra said.

PV Kiran Ananth, Executive Director- Energy Efficiency, Renewable Energy & Green Entrepreneurship, CII Godrej GBC, said energy efficiency remained one of the most cost-effective levers for industrial decarbonisation.

ellery park will bring together a wide range of activities associated with the jewellery industry under a single industrial hub. These would include jewellery manufacturing, design, refining, hallmarking, testing, packaging, logistics and exports. According to the project report, the park is expected to create around 24,000 direct employment opportunities, in addition to a large number of indirect jobs in ancillary industries.

V Sajeew Kumar

Kochi

The Kerala Gold and Silver Merchants Association (KGSM) has submitted a detailed project report to the Chief Minister, proposing the establishment of a modern jewellery park in the State to transform the gold jewellery sector into a more organised and technology-driven industry.

KERALAMASHUB

KGSM President K Surendran and General Secretary S Abdul Nazar said the proposed project is expected to attract investment of more than ₹2,000 crore and would require around 30 acres of land.

Once operational, the jew-

**KERALA WATER AUTHORITY e-Tender Notice**

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QUICKLY.

Dr Reddy's expands Gilead pact for HIV-related drug



Hyderabad: Dr Reddy's Laboratories has entered into a royalty-free non-exclusive voluntary licencing agreement with Gilead Sciences for investigational once-yearly lenacapavir for HIV prevention as pre-exposure prophylaxis. The agreement builds on Dr Reddy's existing voluntary licencing arrangement with Gilead, signed in October 2024. **OUR BUREAU**

TCS' chip design services for auto, semicon sectors

New Delhi: Tata Consultancy Services on Thursday launched its custom system-on-chip (SoC) design services for automotive OEMs and semiconductor ecosystem players. The end-to-end service is designed to help auto manufacturers conceive, design, verify, implement and validate custom SoC solutions for the next generation of software-defined vehicles, TCS said. The company said the custom design services bring together semiconductor engineering, VLSI design, hardware-software co-design, and system validation capabilities. **PII**

E-comm platforms to ramp up gig hiring for festive season

BIG JUMP. India's online retail market expected to cross \$90 billion in CY26

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

The online festive season is shaping up to be its strongest in five years, and the expected surge in shopping is prompting e-commerce and quick-commerce platforms to ramp up hiring of temporary and gig workers across fulfilment, warehousing and last-mile delivery.

Redseer Strategy Consultants expects online retail to grow 25 per cent year-on-year during the 2026 festive period, up sharply from 16 per cent last year. The growth comes as India's online retail market is expected to cross \$90 billion in calendar year 2026, expanding 22-24 per cent from a year earlier.

The stronger festive outlook is translating into higher workforce requirements, as platforms prepare for a spike in order volumes.

According to Deepesh Gupta, Director and Head of Business, General Staffing, Adecco India, festive hiring across e-commerce and quick commerce is expected to rise 15-20 per cent this year, taking the temporary and gig workforce requirement to around 2.5-2.7 lakh (approximately 2.16 lakh).

The scale-up is already vis-



PEAK PERIOD. Festive hiring is expected to rise, taking the workforce requirement to around 2.5-2.7 lakh **V RAJU**

ible at individual platforms. Flipkart said it will create more than 2.5 lakh direct and indirect employment opportunities, including gig workers, for the festive season. Nearly 1.4 lakh of these opportunities will be in last-mile operations, while the company is adding more than 900 festive delivery hubs across its network. Nearly 75,000 opportunities are expected to be for first-time workforce entrants.

Quick commerce is emerging as a bigger contributor to seasonal workforce demand. Gupta estimates the segment will account for 40-45 per cent of festive flexible workforce requirements (30-35 per cent), translating into around 1-1.25 lakh temporary workers.

Redseer expects quick commerce to grow 110-120 per cent year-on-year during the festive period, compared

with 16-18 per cent growth for the rest of e-commerce. The channel could account for nearly one-fifth of festive online retail this year, highlighting its growing influence on both consumption and the workforce needed to service it.

DEMAND DRIVERS

The sharp expansion in quick commerce is also changing the composition of seasonal hiring. Delivery executives, warehouse associates, picker-packers, sorting staff, fleet coordinators and dark-store workers are expected to account for much of the additional demand.

Adecco expects logistics and last-mile delivery hiring to increase 30-35 per cent, while organised retail and e-commerce hiring could rise 25-28 per cent. The hiring footprint is also spreading beyond metros, with around

45 per cent of workforce demand expected from tier-2 and -3 cities, including Lucknow, Bhubaneswar, Jaipur and Coimbatore.

However, staffing firms said competition for front-line workers is intensifying as e-commerce, quick commerce and logistics companies hire simultaneously. Employers are, therefore, relying more on referrals, existing talent pools and incentives to retain workers through the peak period.

Temporary wages are expected to rise 10-15 per cent year-on-year, according to Adecco, with companies using attendance bonuses, retention payouts, productivity-linked incentives and referral bonuses.

TeamLease Services, meanwhile, expects front-line salaries to rise 8-10 per cent in H2 2026, with employers increasingly using variable pay, surge multipliers, fuel and shift allowances and completion bonuses to attract workers.

The demand is being driven by a broad-based festive recovery rather than mobiles and electronics alone. Redseer expects grocery to grow 48-50 per cent, home and furniture 32-35 per cent, BPC 35-40 per cent and fashion 20-22 per cent during the festive period.

Then & now: [Update on last year's winners of Changemaker Awards](#)

From punctures to NASA: Rewiring India's rural innovation pipeline

2025 WINNER.

YOUNG CHANGEMAKER

Richa Mishra
Hyderabad

For decades, India's technological narrative followed a predictable, top-down trajectory. Innovation belonged exclusively to elite urban institutes, corporate R&D hubs and State-backed aerospace agencies. The rest of the country, particularly its tier-3 and -4 villages, was relegated to the role of passive bystanders in the digital revolution.

A meaningful shift occurred when Vaishali Sharma and Anil Pradhan stepped in to build the Young Tinker Foundation, gently but effectively challenging the existing hierarchy.

When the foundation received the *businessline* Changemaker Award 2025 in the Young Changemaker category, many viewed it as a feel-good story about rural education. One year later, it is clear that the accolade was something far more significant — a critical seal of trust that validated a radical educational hypothesis.

By leveraging this recognition to accelerate corporate social responsibility (CSR) partnerships and dismantle bureaucratic barriers within State educational departments, the foundation has proven that the next generation of deep-tech innovators will emerge not just from urban tech hubs. They are waking up in the remote villages of Odisha, the farmlands of Telangana and isolated Himalayan communities.

ROBUST MODEL

Speaking to *businessline*, Pradhan revealed that by 2026, the foundation had directly impacted over 4.3 lakh students across 10 major States. The true genius of the model lies in its operational architecture. Instead of waiting for resource-strapped schools to build dedicated STEM innovation labs, Young Tinker engineered a dynamic hub-and-spoke infrastructure that brings the lab to the child.

Through 12 fixed Centres of Excellence and a fleet of 17 active 'Tinker on Wheels' mobile units, the foundation physically delivers 3D printers, microcontrollers, robotics gear and other hands-on innovation tools to schools that may not have a dedicated STEM innovation lab or the resources to establish one themselves. 'Tinker on Wheels' is specifically designed to reach such schools, including those in communities where access to electricity may itself be limited or unavailable.

This is coupled with a massive international footprint of 3,583 Young Tinker Clubs across schools and universities, both in India



Anil Pradhan and Vaishali Sharma, Co-founders of the Young Tinker Foundation



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and internationally, bringing together students from rural communities, urban institutions and global campuses. The Clubs are open to learners irrespective of geography, creating a peer-to-peer network, where access to knowledge and opportunities is not determined by postal codes.

The socio-economic impact of this infrastructure is profound, as shared by Pradhan. Consider Kailash, the son of a roadside bicycle mechanic. In a traditional system, his mechanical aptitude would likely have been confined to fixing punctures. Under the Young Tinker mantle, he served as the mechanical lead for an Indian team that secured World Rank 3 at the NASA Human Exploration Rover Challenge. Similarly, Rishikesh, a 16-year-old from an agrarian community, built an AI-powered pest prediction system that earned direct funding from Intel.

While the foundation has mapped out an ambitious three-to-five-year roadmap, which includes introducing CubeSats, advanced AI and spatial computing to rural classrooms, the limits of solo non-profit scaling are clear. To turn this grassroots spark into a systemic, nationwide wildfire, institutional stakeholders must step up. "The question is no longer whether India's rural youth have the capacity to innovate," Pradhan said. "The question is whether the rest of society has the resolve to give them the wheels to do so."

Health Ministry issues advisory on stem cell therapy trials

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

Stem cell therapy will be offered as standard clinical care only for disease conditions and indications approved by the Health Ministry, restricting its use to approved clinical trials for

autism spectrum disorder.

In an advisory issued on September 16, the Ministry reiterated the existing regulatory framework for stem cell research and therapy, and asked the States to ensure that unproven stem cell interventions are not offered as routine, standard or commercial clinical services.

The advisory comes in the wake of a Supreme Court judgment, which dealt with the regulation of stem cell therapy.

STRICT COMPLIANCE

For autism, the Ministry specifically said that therapeutic use of any type of stem cell will remain restricted to

duly-approved clinical trials.

Such trials will have to comply with the National Guidelines for Stem Cell Research, 2017, issued jointly by the Indian Council of Medical Research and the Department of Biotechnology, along with other applicable government instructions.

The government advisory also mentions the consequences of offering stem cell therapy outside the approved framework, and said the Supreme Court had held that non-compliance with the statutory requirements must attract consequences, including relating to professional misconduct.

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